Interpersonal & Group Processes (IGP)

End-Term Open-Book Notes

PGP-I 2026-27 · IGP-D (T2) · Aditya Aggarwal

What this is built from. The Moodle session plan (S1–S15), every session deck and "What's on the board" photo, all assigned readings, the seven course cases (Ramesh & Gargi, Go Around AXB1344, Strike in Space, Paul McGinley, Henry Tam & MGI, Greg James at Sun, Asian Toys) and the past papers (2012 recall, 2020 paper + Satera case, 2022 paper with marking scheme).

How to use it in the exam (3 moves).

1. **Part A**: find the question type, which tells you the framework and the answer template the marking scheme rewards.
2. **Part B**: framework definitions and lists, session by session, in the professor's vocabulary.
3. **Part C**: case evidence banks with pre-classified levels (H / M / L), quotes and p.8-style page refs to the original case PDF. **Part D** has cross-case compare/contrast tables; **Part E** has past-paper questions with model outlines.

Legend: **H** = high, **M** = moderate, **L** = low. "Board" = the professor's "What's on the board" photo for that session.

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A · Exam Playbook

A1 · What the paper looks like

- **35 marks · 3 hours · 5–6 questions** (4–6 marks each). Open book, open notes.
- **2022 (offline):** handwritten answers in fixed boxes; laptops, calculators and mobiles not allowed in the hall. **2020 (online):** typed, with word limits of 250–350 words per question; words beyond the limit were not evaluated.
- Every question has the same shape: **named framework + named case(s) + "provide evidence from the case"**. Some ask you to *compare* two or three cases, or to say *what the manager should do* (2 implementable suggestions per item).
- **An unseen case can be attached**. 2020 shipped the Satera case with the paper and mixed it with course cases. So know the frameworks well enough to apply them to fresh facts; Part B is for that.
- Time budget: about 5 minutes per mark. Do the questions on cases you know first; leave 15 minutes to re-read.

Topic	2012	2020	2022	2026 session
Big Five on a character	–	Q5 Satera	Q4 Ellen Moore	S1
Fit (P-O, P-J, P-G, P-S)	–	Q6 Satera, Ghomeshi, **Gibson**	Q3 Tough Guy, **Gibson**	S2
Diversity: compare & contrast	–	Q2 Satera vs **Henry Tam**	Q2 **Henry Tam**, Microsign, Ellen Moore	S14, S10
Conflict types + resolution	Q1 Meena–Nitish	Q1 Satera	–	S11, S6, S8
Interpersonal trust	–	Q3 **Henry–Dana, Henry–Sasha**	–	S2, S11
Voice: motivators/inhibitors	–	Q4 Ghomeshi, Satera	–	S4
Multicultural interventions	–	–	Q1 Ellen Moore	S10
Process losses	–	–	Q5 Ellen Moore	S12–13
Networking	–	–	Q6 Ellen, **Gargi**, **Dana**	S3
Power sources	Q2 Bob Knowlton	–	–	S6
Group development (Tuckman)	Q5 Ek Ruka Hua Faisla	–	–	S10
Negotiation learnings	Q6 X-Y game	–	–	S5
Learnings in PLP format	Q3 **Asian Toys**	–	–	S15

Bold = a case that is also in your 2026 folder. Transactional analysis (2012) is not in the 2026 session plan.

A2 · How marks are awarded (decoded from the 2022 marking scheme)

Question type	Scheme	What it means for you
Big Five	1 mark per trait = 0.5 for the trait level + 0.5 for case evidence. "Irrespective of the classification, as long as the student defends the choice, full marks."	Cover all five traits. A defended "Moderate" scores; an undefended "High" does not.
Fit	0.5 for the correct level (high / moderate / low) per fit + 0.5 for one instance from the case. No marks for just naming the fit type.	Write "P-S fit: **LOW**, because ..." for each type. One good instance per fit is enough.
Multicultural interventions	1 mark for the intervention name + 1 for a correct example. Wrong name: 0. Partial example: 0.5. Only one example graded.	Use the exact labels: Adaptation, Structural intervention, Managerial intervention, Exit.
Diversity compare	At least 2 similarities + 2 differences. 1.5 each when the *type* of diversity and the *evidence* are both clear; 0.75 if only one is clear.	Name the type (surface: nationality, age, gender, language; deep: values, cognitive style, function, tenure) and give the fact from each case.
Process losses	1 per category (0.5 type + 0.5 evidence); at least one from each category; extra examples in one category are not counted.	Cover the categories: Conformity, Participation, Decision-making biases, Conflict, Influence imbalance.
Networking ("Learn to Love Networking")	Four core ideas × 1.5 (0.5 per person, with evidence). Any defended classification is accepted.	Build a grid: idea × person, one fact per cell.

Rule of thumb. Name the concept exactly as taught → give the level or label → one crisp case fact (who did what, with page) → optionally one line of "so what". Never give two examples where one is graded; spend the words on a better single example.

A3 · Question → framework → answer template

If the question asks...	Use (where)	Template that scores
"Evaluate X on the Big Five"	S1 · Big Five table	O, C, E, A, N → level + one behaviour (page). Split facets if evidence is mixed (e.g., high achievement-striving C, low dutifulness C).
"Fit of X with team / org / supervisor / job"	S2 · Kristof-Brown	P-O, P-J, P-G, P-S → level + instance. If it says "supervisor (immediate or otherwise)", rate both (e.g., Gibson: Carr H, Mission Control L).
"Identify types of conflict" / "how to resolve"	S11 conflict types; S6 antecedents; S8 mediation	Task / Relationship / Process / Status → definition + incident. Resolution: two implementable steps per type (who, what, when), e.g., mediation (separate then joint), decision criteria, role charter.
"Rate trust between A and B"	S2 Abrams (benevolence vs competence); S11 Dinh (cognitive vs affective)	Overall rating → competence/cognitive evidence → benevolence/affective evidence → direction (building or eroding) → which trust builder (#1–10) would fix it.
"Factors motivating / inhibiting voice"	S4 Morrison table; fear & futility; psychological safety	Two motivators + two inhibitors per case, each tagged with its level (individual, job/org, emotion, supervisor, context) + fact.
"Compare diversity across cases"	S14 surface vs deep; D1	Three-column table: dimension | case 1 | case 2 → two or more similarities and two or more differences, each naming the type of diversity.

If the question asks…	Use (where)	Template that scores
"Interventions in a multicultural team"	S10 Brett, Behfar & Kern	Adaptation / Structural / Managerial / Exit → name + example (+ enabling condition).
"Sources of process loss"	S12–13; Note on Team Process	Conformity (groupthink, Abilene) · Participation (uneven, social loafing, bystander) · Decision biases (common-knowledge effect, rushing to a solution) · Conflict (personal abrasion) · Influence (status over expertise) → one each + fact.
"Sources of power"	S6 French & Raven + informational + relational; Pfeffer	Positional (legitimate, reward, coercive) · Personal (expert, referent) · Informational · Relational → evidence each; mention counter-power of the less powerful side.
"Influence tactics used"	S7 Kipnis list; framing / information / technical authority; status push vs pull	Tactic → incident → why it worked (or backfired).
"How effective a networker is X"	S3 Ibarra & Hunter; Uzzi & Dunlap	Operational (depth) · Personal (breadth) · Strategic (leverage) → evidence; network shape (closed vs brokerage).
"Explain the team's behaviour via stages"	S10 Tuckman; punctuated equilibrium	Stage → observed behaviour → what moves the team on (norms, roles, midpoint reset).
"Team roles / styles"	S9 Belbin; Business Chemistry	Role → behaviour; missing or excess roles ("too many shapers → conflict").
"What should the manager do?"	S4, S8, S10, S11 levers	Diagnose with one framework → 3–5 actions sequenced (now / 30 days / structural) → one risk and its mitigation.
"Prepare a negotiation"	S5 Lewicki 4 steps	Issues → positions → interests (substantive, process, relationship, principle) → options (logroll, bridge, nonspecific compensation…) → objective criteria → walk-away.
"Your learnings (PLP format)"	2012 Q3; S15	What happened → what I felt/noticed → concept that explains it → what I learned about myself → what I will do differently.

A4 · Writing pattern & checklists

C-L-E-I pattern. **C**oncept (exact label) → **L**evel/label → **E**vidence (who did what, page) → **I**mplication.
Example (Gibson, P-O fit): "P-O fit: **LOW**. NASA selected astronauts for 'military discipline and obedience' and Mission Control prided itself on programming 'every minute'; Gibson, 'one of the contrariest', wanted only 'a bare framework… a shopping list' p.1, 5, 7, 9. The misfit fed the strike."

Do: use a table for compare/contrast; label every item; quote 3–8 words from the case; separate the immediate and higher supervisor; for recommendations give actor + action + timing + framework.
Don't: describe the framework at length (one line is enough); moralise; repeat the case story; leave a trait or fit type unrated.

If an unseen case is attached: read it once for the story, then scan for (1) every person's quoted behaviour → Big Five and fit; (2) every disagreement → conflict type; (3) every silence or hesitation → voice inhibitors; (4) team composition table → diversity; (5) meetings → process losses. Mark these in the margin with S1/S2/S11/S4/S14/S12 before writing.

B · Frameworks by Session

S1 · Personality: the Big Five (Interpersonal Orientation)

Sources: S1 slides; Robbins, Judge & Vohra (2022) ch. 5 "Personality and Values"; "Find your OCEAN" scoring sheet.

Definitions. APA (2017): "individual differences in characteristic patterns of thinking, feeling and behaving." Allport: "the dynamic organization within the individual of those psychophysical systems that determine his unique adjustments to his environment." Robbins: "the sum total of ways in which an individual reacts to and interacts with others." Personality explains preferences for behaviour, develops early, explains everyday behaviour and is easy to observe.

Stability. Mostly heritable (45–60% per trait, slides; twin studies ≈50%). Rank order is stable in adults, but personality can shift with life events and organizational factors; it changes more in adolescence.

Measurement. Self-reports can be faked (job applicants rate themselves about ½ SD more conscientious and stable); observer ratings predict job success better; use both.

MBTI: E/I, S/N, T/F, J/P → 16 types. Widely used (Infosys, Citigroup, GE) but weak validity, forces people into types, unrelated to job performance → use for self-awareness, not selection.

Trait	What it captures (facets)	High: strengths	High: weaknesses	Low: strengths	Low: weaknesses · work outcomes
O · Openness to experience ("intellect / imagination")	Interest in new or unusual things; willing to try new things, be vulnerable, think outside the box; curious, creative, artistically sensitive.	Visionary, imaginative, strategically focused, drives change, long-term, adaptive.	Ignores current realities; indifferent to SOPs and implementation concerns.	Realistic, pragmatic, grasps what's happening, uses factual data, respects tradition.	Here-and-now focus; "analysis paralysis"; misses big picture; formality. *Outcomes*: learning, creativity, leadership, copes with change.
C · Conscientiousness ("work ethic")	Structured, organized life; controls impulses; duty and achievement striving; plans, works within rules, delays gratification.	Reliable, predictable, delegates well, lots of drive, good at goal setting.	Pushes for closure, sticks with plans, oversimplifies complexity, obsessive about control.	Responsive to change, quick responder, pressure-prompted (works in crisis).	Easily distracted, chaotic, unreliable. *Outcomes*: strongest predictor of job performance, job knowledge, career success, longevity; less adaptable, less creative.
E · Extraversion ("interpersonal patterns")	Gets energy from others; dominant in groups; sociability, dominance, ambition, excitement seeking.	Action-oriented, good at networking and informed, communicative, seen as leader and as transparent.	Acts before reflecting; thinking aloud confuses; can steamroll introverts; weak at solo work.	Effective listener, reflective, team contributor, good with solitary work.	Aloof, fails to communicate, unassertive, hard to read, seen as unfriendly or arrogant. *Outcomes*: leadership emergence, social skills, well-being, overconfidence.
A · Agreeableness	"Go along to get along"; orientation to others; cooperation, trustfulness, compliance, affability.	Strong relationship builder, cares, trusting and charitable, effective coach.	Transparent and predictable; easily taken for a ride.	Analytical and rational, thick-skinned, makes tough calls.	Alienates people, conflict, low trust, uber-competitive. *Outcomes*: better liked, rule-abiding, citizenship; lower earnings.
N · Neuroticism (low N = emotional stability)	Propensity to negative emotions: anger, anxiety, worry, fear, depression, insecurity. An emotional reaction, not a disorder.	Barometer of crisis, attuned to risk, won't let team slack, passionate, responsive to coaching.	Emotional, worry, burnout, performance anxiety, temperamental, easily angered, over-responsive to feedback.	Calm under pressure, resilient, keeps others calm, even-keeled, sure of self.	Unresponsive to feedback, overconfident, too laid back; calm can lull team into complacency. *Outcomes*: stability → job/life satisfaction, lower stress.

Research nuggets (slides). High N → poorer performance and motivation (Judge & Ilies 2002) but can help in busy, high-effort settings (Smillie 2006). Team performance rises with **mean team C** and **minimum A** (stronger in professional teams); low N helps professional teams. Entrepreneurs score higher on C and O and lower on N and A than managers. Big Five replicate across cultures, including India.

Class OCEAN scoring cut-offs (average of 10 items each): E <2.86 low · 2.86–3.48 avg · >3.48 high; A <2.90 · 2.90–3.42 · >3.42; C <2.98 · 2.98–3.62 · >3.62; N <2.15 · 2.15–2.97 · >2.97; O <3.17 · 3.17–3.73 · >3.73. "So what": know what feels natural, understand and influence others, move from irritation → acceptance → complementing each other.

Other traits (Robbins)	Meaning · use in answers
Dark Triad	**Machiavellianism** (pragmatic, emotional distance, ends justify means); **Narcissism** (grandiose, needs admiration, entitled, arrogant); **Psychopathy** (no concern for others, no guilt). Linked to counterproductive behaviour, hard influence tactics.
Core self-evaluation · Self-monitoring · Proactive personality	CSE: belief in own capability and worth. High self-monitors adjust behaviour to situations (better ratings, emerge as leaders); low self-monitors are "true to myself" (Jyothi example). Proactive: spot opportunities, take initiative, persevere.
Situation strength	Personality predicts behaviour better in **weak** situations. Strength = **clarity, consistency, constraints, consequences** of cues. (A cockpit with SOPs is a "strong" situation; a start-up team is "weak".)
Trait activation	Some situations activate traits: detail orientation → C+; social skills → E+, A+; competitive work → E+, A−; innovation → O+; dealing with angry people → E+, A+, N−; time pressure → C+, N−.

S2 · Managing Interpersonal Relationships

Case: Ramesh & Gargi (A). Reading: Roberts et al. (2005) "How to Play to Your Strengths". Slides: Rusbult et al. (1988); Katz (1974); Kristof-Brown et al. (2005); Abrams et al. (2003).

EVLN: responses of a dissatisfied employee (Rusbult et al. 1988)

	Constructive	Destructive
Active	**VOICE**: discuss problems, seek help, seek feedback.	**EXIT**: formally separate, move out.
Passive	**LOYALTY**: wait patiently, hope things improve (tolerate).	**NEGLECT**: ignore the relationship, spend less time, reduce effort (silent).

Board: Ramesh drifting from loyalty/neglect toward exit; the class answer was to use his STRENGTHS to move to VOICE.

Katz (1974): skills of an effective administrator

Technical skills dominate at entry level; human skills matter at every level and most for middle managers; conceptual/strategic skills dominate at the top. Board for Ramesh: strong technical HR skill, needs the human and strategic-conceptual skills of a department head.

Fit (Kristof-Brown, Zimmerman & Johnson 2005): compatibility between the individual and the work environment when characteristics are well matched

Fit	Match between the person and…	Job satisfaction	Intent to quit	Overall performance
P-J	the job or tasks performed (demands–abilities; needs–supplies).	.56	−.46	.20
P-O	the organization's culture, climate, values, goals.	.44	−.35	.07
P-G	the work group (interpersonal compatibility with co-workers).	.31	−.22	.19
P-S	the supervisor (dyadic relationship).	.44	–	.18

P-J fit predicts both satisfaction and performance best; P-O fit predicts satisfaction and intent to quit but barely performance. At pre-entry there is too little information to judge P-G and P-S fit (which is how Ramesh got blindsided by Gargi's arrival).

Interpersonal trust (Abrams, Cross, Lesser & Levin 2003)

Trust = "the willingness of a party to be vulnerable." Transparent communication is the currency for building trust continuously. Two bases: **benevolence trust** (you care about me and won't harm me) and **competence trust** (you know what you are talking about). S11 adds the same split as **affective** vs **cognitive** trust.

#	Trust builder	Promotes	Managerial actions
Trustworthy behaviours			
1	Act with discretion	Benevolence	Be clear what is confidential; don't reveal what you said you wouldn't; hold others accountable for this.
2	Be consistent between word and deed	Benevolence + competence	Be clear what you committed to; set realistic expectations, then deliver.
3	Ensure frequent and rich communication	Benevolence + competence	Make interactions meaningful; some face-to-face (or phone) contact; develop close relationships.
4	Engage in collaborative communication	Benevolence + competence	Don't be overly critical of ideas in their infancy; don't demand complete solutions; improve partially formed ideas jointly.
5	Ensure decisions are fair and transparent	Benevolence	People know how and why personnel rules are applied, equally; clear promotion and reward criteria (no hidden agendas).
Organizational factors			
6	Establish shared vision and language	Benevolence + competence	Set common goals early; common terminology; watch for jargon misunderstandings.
7	Hold people accountable for trust	Benevolence + competence	Include trustworthiness in appraisals; don't reward untrustworthy high performers; publicise rewarded and punished examples.
Relational factors			
8	Create personal connections	Benevolence	Human connection on non-work commonalities; keep up quality contact; never divulge confidences.
9	Give away something of value	Benevolence	Take risks in sharing expertise; offer your network of contacts.
Individual factors			
10	Disclose your expertise and limitations	Competence	Say what you do and don't know; admit ignorance rather than posture; defer to those who know more.

How to Play to Your Strengths: Reflected Best Self (RBS) exercise

People remember criticism but respond to praise (positive organizational scholarship; teams hearing about 5 positives per negative perform better, Losada & Heaphy).

1. **Identify respondents and ask for feedback**: 10–20 people from family, friends, past and present colleagues; ask for specific stories of you at your best.
2. **Recognize patterns**: cluster into a table of common theme | examples | possible interpretation.
3. **Compose your self-portrait**: 2–4 paragraphs of prose starting "When I am at my best, I...".
4. **Redesign your job**: small changes in how you work, team composition and use of time (Robert → program manager in 9 months; James quit and founded a company; Sarah won an executive role).

Caveats: not ego-stroking; needs follow-through; run it away from appraisal season. Board: STRENGTHS → (ask) Know → Find (themes) → Redesign.

Other board concepts (S2)

- **Competent jerk vs lovable star** (Casciaro & Lobo, "Competent jerks, lovable fools"): Ramesh saw Gargi as a "competent jerk"; Kamla and the seniors saw a "star". Gargi's moves: works with the boss's boss, networks, takes initiative.
- **Kamla**: trust depends on transparent communication.
- **Perception grid** (self vs others' views): each person's self-view differed sharply from how others saw them (see C1), which is why each side attributes bad intent.
- **Fit verdict for Ramesh**: P-O ✓, P-J ✓, P-G ×, P-S ×.

S3 · Knowing and Building Relationships: Networks

Reading: Ibarra & Hunter (2007) "How Leaders Create and Use Networks". Slides: Uzzi & Dunlap (2005); McKeown (2015); Kuwabara (2013); Dunbar (1992).

	Closed / dense network (A)	Open / brokerage network (B)
Shape	Your contacts know each other: low diversity, high redundancy, no brokerage.	Your contacts don't know each other: high diversity, low redundancy, you broker.
Gives	Trust, back-up talent, speed to consensus, emotional support, cohesion.	Diverse information and talent, creativity, informal power, competition.
Risk	Echo chambers.	Less support; harder to build trust.

Degree centrality: number of connections. **Betweenness centrality**: connections to people not connected to each other; you lie on the shortest path between others, so you "broker". A social network is a pattern of informal ties; business and friendship overlap (embeddedness); the pattern of ties matters.

How we pick ties (Uzzi & Dunlap)	Why	Limitation / remedy
Referral by current network	Existing contacts introduce new ones.	Reproduces the same circle.
Self-similarity	Trust (predictable), comfort zone, immediate utility, self-affirmation, "joy of spontaneous agreement".	Less discrepant information, stifled problem-solving and creativity, echo chambers.
Proximity	Same department/team; frequency; organizing by distance.	Echo chambers; your network becomes structurally equivalent to peers' (no differentiation).
Shared activity (best)	A cross-section of disparate people around a common interest: team sports, community service, cross-functional teams, volunteer groups. Builds diversity, trust (common goals, visible character, bonding over wins and losses) and brokerage.	Works best with **passion**, **interdependence** and **stakes**.

Myths vs reality. Myths: networking is for the incompetent, unethical, manipulative; "my brilliance will be noticed"; "no time"; "I'm shy/introvert". Reality: quality beats quantity; Dunbar's number ≈150 stable relationships; much networking is wasted time (McKeown). Networking = **relational fitness** (Kuwabara): dedicating time, energy and resources to social ties.

Takeaways (slide). Build a **diversified portfolio** of redundant ties (support, trust) and entrepreneurial ties (information, control), including "undervalued" people. Expand through shared activities, by using your human and social capital to help others, and through brokers. Find chances to broker and become non-substitutable. Maintain the network (be generous). Align your goals with the organization's.

Ibarra & Hunter: three forms of networking

	Operational	Personal	Strategic
Purpose	Get work done efficiently; maintain the group's capacities and functions.	Personal and professional development; referrals to useful information and contacts.	Figure out future priorities and challenges; get stakeholder support for them.
Location & time	Mostly internal; current demands.	Mostly external; current and future interests.	Internal and external; oriented to the future.
Players	Non-discretionary, prescribed by task and structure; clear who's relevant.	Mostly discretionary; not always clear who's relevant.	Follow from strategic context, but membership discretionary.
Key attribute	**Depth**: strong working relationships.	**Breadth**: contacts who can make referrals.	**Leverage**: inside-outside links; indirect influence.
Example	Alistair cleaned up the books but missed that most of the board opposed an IPO.	Timothy beat his stutter at social events; a factory head found a lawyer and two mentors.	Sophie lacked one and was blindsided by a reorg; Jody refused "political games" and lost her unit.

Leverage your networks: mind your mind-set (find an ethical role model: Gabriel Chenard); work from the outside in (Linda Henderson's theatre evenings with clients); reallocate your time (delegate; Henrik locked himself in his office and was out of the loop); ask and you shall receive (give and take continually, connect two people); stick to it (Harris Roberts dropped networking in a crunch and stayed a functional

manager). Networking is a skill, not a talent, and does not need an extroverted personality. Most managers under-use strategic networking.

Not on the 2026 list but asked in 2022: "Learn to Love Networking" (Casciaro, Gino & Kouchaki 2016), four ideas: (1) **Focus on learning** (promotion, not prevention, mind-set); (2) **Identify common interests**; (3) **Think broadly about what you can give**; (4) **Find a higher purpose** for networking.

S4 · Speaking Up in Groups and Teams: Voice Behaviour

Case: Go Around AXB1344. Readings: Detert & Burris (2016); Hadley, Mortensen & Edmondson (2023); Detert (2018). Slides: Morrison (2014); speak-up and silence cycles.

Voice (Morrison 2014) = *informal and/or discretionary* communication *of* ideas, suggestions, concerns, information *about* problems or opinions on work-related issues *to* persons who might be able to take appropriate action, *with* the intent to bring improvement or change. Risks of speaking up: looking ignorant (asking for help), incompetent, intrusive, negative.

Level	Motivators	Inhibitors
Individual disposition	Extraversion, conscientiousness	Achievement orientation
Job & org perceptions	Organizational identification, job satisfaction, organizational support	Detachment, powerlessness
Emotions	Anger, psychological safety	Fear, futility, image or career risk
Supervisor behaviour	Ethical and transformational leadership, consultation	Abusive leadership
Context	Caring climate, formal voice mechanisms	Job and social stressors, hierarchical structure, climate of fear or silence

Two critical reasons for silence: **Fear** (stalled promotion/transfer, no rewards, negative action by supervisor, ridicule by team members, looking incompetent, labelled a problem-creator) and **Futility** ("my suggestions will never be implemented", "nobody listens here", "I'll never know what gets implemented"). At one Fortune 100 firm futility was cited about twice as often as fear.

Psychological safety (Edmondson): the shared belief that it is OK to take risks, express ideas and concerns, ask questions and admit mistakes without fear of negative consequences. Benefits: information sharing, satisfaction, learning, performance, engagement, inclusion, creativity, lower turnover, reputation.

Speak-up cycle: employee speaks up → leader listens well (curiosity, respect, thanks) → action/response → feedback/ closure → voice efficacy rises ("my voice matters") → more voice, better outcomes.
Silence cycle: employee speaks up → leader dismisses, gets defensive, or nothing happens → "my voice doesn't matter" → perceived efficacy falls → speaks less or only on safe issues → silence; concerns stay hidden. *Turning point: how leaders respond in the moment. "Every response teaches."*

Board: the asymmetry of voice.
Speak → benefits the **organization**, in the **long term**, and is **intangible/ambiguous**.
Don't speak → benefits **self**, **now**, and is **clear** (instant safety).
Ambiguous threats are high-risk: the culture asks you to "prove it is unsafe" rather than "prove it is safe". **Failures percolate** (Swiss cheese): individual (training: PIC, FO) → supervisory → organization → regulator → infrastructure → DISASTER.

AXB slide concept	Content
Psychological safety: the last line of defence	**Antecedents** (leader behaviour, team structures, context support; AIXL: authoritarian captains unchecked, leadership fragmented across four cities, no coaching) → **team belief** (is it safe to speak up? AIXL: "stiff and closed", challenging a captain seen as disruptive) → **behaviour** (questions, error discussion, challenge; AXB1344: no briefing for Runway 10, hedged call-outs, controls never taken) → **outcome** (the overrun and 21 lives). *Training FOs to "be assertive" cannot work while the antecedents stay untouched.*
Voice ≠ agency	Escalating verbal risk: "Rate of descent" (technical call-out, low risk) → "Rate of descent... Captain" (personalised challenge, moderate) → "Just check it" (hedged request, moderate) → "Captain?" (a plea, high) → "Go around" (direct command, highest verbal risk) → **taking control** (authorised and required by SOP; never taken). The FO had enough psychological safety to speak, but not enough to act.
Single- vs double-loop learning (Argyris)	**Single loop**: fix the error inside existing assumptions (AIXL after Mangalore: documents revised, compliance reports filed, action items closed; cut SMS training 5 → 3 days and then amended the manual to legitimise the cut). **Double loop**: question the assumptions (why does our culture subordinate safety to operations? why do authority gradients persist despite CRM? why has paperwork replaced change?). **Espoused theory** ("safety first" in SMS manuals and CRM syllabi) vs **theory-in-use** (operations first, deviation tolerated, dissent suppressed).
Why organizations don't learn (Gino & Staats, HBR 2015)	Bias toward **success** (destigmatize failure, growth mind-set, consider potential, data-driven decisions); toward **action** (build breaks, take time to think, encourage reflection); toward **fitting in** (cultivate strengths, remove conformity, lead by example); toward **experts** (let employees own problems, give varied experience, empower them to use it).
Psychological safety × accountability (Edmondson)	Low/low = **Apathy**; high safety, low accountability = **Comfort**; low safety, high accountability = **Anxiety** (AIXL's FOs); high/high = **Learning zone**.

Detert & Burris (2016): Can your employees really speak freely?

Mistakes that feed FEAR	Mistakes that feed FUTILITY	Best practices
Relying on anonymous feedback: signals "it isn't safe here", sets off witch hunts, makes it hard to act. **General invitations** ("open door") are too passive. **Signals that you're in charge** (ambient power cues: leaning back, big desk, bigger chair).	**Failing to model free expression** (task force hid top-management problems). **Being unclear about the input you want** ("pseudoparticipation", vague calls). **Providing no resources** to address issues.	Make feedback a **regular, casual** face-to-face exchange (thank the first brave souls; adopt at least one idea and credit it). Be **transparent** about the process and timeline. **Reach out** (MBWA; proactive asking raised voice about twice as much as mere openness). **Soften power cues** (round table, equal chairs; Ken Freeman's glass office). **Avoid mixed messages**. **Be the example**: represent their ideas upward (cuts futility; +10% voice). **Close the loop**: failing to close it raised futility 30%; closing it → 19% more speaking up. Payoff: one restaurant chain cut turnover 32% and saved $1.6M a year.

Hadley, Mortensen & Edmondson (2023): Make it safe to speak up, especially in risky times. Voice benefits the organization (delayed, uncertain); silence gives the individual instant, certain safety, so leaders must make speaking up worth it. Audit yourself first (Petriglieri: time turns the fear of speaking truth *to* power into the fear of speaking truth *in* power). **Winning formula**: (1) **clarify the rationale** (link voice to strategy, now); (2) **issue targeted invitations** (monthly 1:1 with two items: "What should I know, but don't, right now?" and "How can I better support your risk-taking?"); (3) **stamp out punishments** (bad is stronger than good; apologize fast); (4) **stack up rewards** (thank often; build candor into appraisals and promotions).

Detert (2018): Cultivating everyday courage. "Competently courageous" people: (1) **Lay the groundwork**: earn *idiosyncrasy credits* (record of competence and fitting in; Catherine Gill at Root Capital), earn trust, improve fallback options (Franco Bernabè refused perks). (2) **Choose your battles**: is it really important? is this the right time? (Mandy waited six months and gathered evidence; Tachi Yamada used a merger as a burning platform). (3) **Persuade in the moment**: frame to the audience's priorities (Mel Exon's BBH Labs and the "black sheep"), use data, manage emotions (Erik stayed calm). (4) **Follow up**: thank and share credit, repair relationships (Gill checked in with the CEO), keep advocating, learn from setbacks (Fred Keller). Start with small acts; keep values and purpose front and centre.

S5 · Negotiation

Reading: Lewicki et al. "Strategy and Tactics of Integrative Negotiation" (ch. 3). Slides: Robbins; Thompson, Wang & Gunia (2010).

Definitions. A process in which two or more parties exchange goods or services and try to agree on the exchange rate (Robbins). "An interpersonal decision-making process when we cannot achieve our objectives single-handedly", i.e., when parties are interdependent (Thompson et al.). Know yourself (needs, wants, goals), know the other side, know the situation (deal/no deal; distributive/integrative; conflict).

Issue = what is negotiated (price of the software). **Position** = what people say they want (Maya: ₹12,00,000 for a subscription). **Interest** = why they want it (Maya's company needs a prestigious client like the school for credibility and visibility).

Dual concern model	Low concern for own outcome	High concern for own outcome
High concern for other	Accommodation	**Collaboration** (integrative)
Low concern for other	Avoidance	Competition (distributive)

	Distributive	Integrative
Goal	Get as much of the pie as possible	Expand the pie so all are satisfied
Motivation	Win-lose	Win-win
Focus	Positions	Interests
Info sharing	Low	High
Duration	Short term	Long term

Importance to me	To them	What to do
Low	High	Concede strategically
High	Low	Protect; seek compensation
High	High	Negotiate carefully
Low	Low	Settle quickly

Multiple issues create possibilities; differing priorities create value (price, timeline, risk, payment terms, support, future business). **Steps**: prepare → influence → signal → propose → exchange offers → close → (dis)agree. **Prepare** your starting point, wants, real needs, what you'll sacrifice, priorities, constraints (economic, time, legal); the other side's needs and constraints; common issues; where conflict will occur.

Common mistakes: inadequate preparation; not problem-solving; not listening (tone, key issues, signals); pulling rank or browbeating; letting price dominate other interests; scoring points; aggression; arguing; ignoring conflict; impatience; not ending on a positive note; neglecting the other side's concerns; partisan perceptions ("our side is morally upright").

Tricky tactics & counters: phony facts → cross-check independently; ambiguous authority ("my boss must approve") → find out who has authority first, insist on reciprocity; good guy/bad guy → recognize the manipulation, ask for reasons; stressful settings designed to rush you → name it, take a break, change venue.

Integrative negotiation (Lewicki): process and steps

Integrative negotiators show honesty and integrity, an abundance mentality, maturity (Covey), a systems orientation and superior listening. **Process**: create a free flow of information; understand the other's real needs and objectives; emphasize commonalities and minimize differences; search for solutions that meet both sides' goals.

Step	How
1 · Identify and define the problem (create value)	Define it in a way both accept; state it practically and comprehensively; state it as a goal and identify obstacles; depersonalize; separate the definition from the search for solutions (agree on standards: "How will we know the problem is solved?"). Example: rejects between sub-assembly and final assembly resolved by returning rejects in slack periods and cross-training.
2 · Surface interests and needs	Ask "why?" (library window: fresh air vs no draft → open a window in the next room). **Types of interest** (Lax & Sebenius), each intrinsic or instrumental: **substantive** (price, resources), **process** (how it is negotiated; having a voice), **relationship** (future of the relationship), **interests in principle** (fairness, ethics, precedent). Interests are layered, differ between parties, come from basic needs (Maslow), change over time, and are not always easy or wise to surface.
3 · Generate alternative solutions	**Redefine the problem**: expand the pie (add resources); **logroll** (trade low-priority issues for high-priority ones; unbundle a single issue); modify the pie; **bridge** (new option meeting both sides' underlying interests); **nonspecific compensation** (pay in an unrelated currency); **cut the costs of compliance** (minimize the other's cost of agreeing); **superordination** (the interest causing the conflict is replaced by another); compromise (not a win-win). **Generate options for the problem as given**: brainstorming, nominal groups, surveys, electronic brainstorming.
4 · Evaluate and select (claim value)	Narrow the range; judge on quality, objective standards and acceptability; agree criteria before evaluating; be willing to justify preferences; watch intangibles; use subgroups for complex options; take time out to cool off; logroll on differences in risk preference, expectations and timing; keep formality low until final agreement.

Factors that facilitate integrative negotiation: a common objective (shared, common or joint goals); faith in one's problem-solving ability; belief in the validity of one's own position *and* the other's perspective; motivation and commitment to work together; trust; clear and accurate communication; understanding the dynamics of integrative negotiation. **Why it is hard**: history of the relationship, belief that the issue can only be resolved distributively, mixed-motive situations.

S6 · Power (and Conflict)

Case: Strike in Space. Reading: Pfeffer (2010) "Power Play". Slides: French & Raven (1959); Soga et al. (2022) on relational power. Board: "Conflict & Powerplay", with the sources grouped as positional (legitimate, reward, coercive), personal (expert, referent), relational (network) and informational.

What power is. Power = the *potential* ability to influence the behaviour of others: potential, because you can hold power and choose not to use it (slide). Pfeffer: simply "the ability to have things your way" when you need other people's effort and they have their own ideas.
Related ideas. *Authority* is legitimate power that comes with a position. *Influence* is power in use: the S7 tactics are how it gets exercised. *Status* (respect, prominence, prestige; S7) sits close to referent power.
Power is relational. It exists only towards someone who needs what you control, so one person can be powerful with one party and powerless with another (Ramesh with his team vs with Kamla). The weaker side holds **counter-power** when the stronger depends on it: Skylab's crew stopped work, and MGI needed an HBS student to enter the contest.
Slide questions. Is power a good thing? Do people shy away from using it? Pfeffer's answer: yes, they shy away, because of three barriers, yet power-motivated managers are the most effective.
Takeaways (slide). Conflict and power exist in interpersonal relations. **Combinations of sources make people powerful or powerless.** Managers should build collaboration to reduce conflict.

Conflict, power and politics are natural outcomes of organizing (slide). The four antecedents of conflict, with Skylab evidence:

Antecedent	Meaning · Strike in Space
Goal incompatibility	The parties chase different goals: maximum experiments to justify $2.5 billion vs crew health and pace p.2, 11, 13.
Differentiation	Different backgrounds, training, beliefs: engineers vs astronauts, a civilian scientist vs military pilots, rookies vs veterans p.5, 7.
Task interdependence	One side's work depends on the other's: the ground plans, the crew executes p.1, 9.
Limited resources	Scarce crew time, about $4 million a week, Mission Control staff cut from 270 to 240 p.3, 6, 11.

Pfeffer adds why goals clash: "where you stand depends on where you sit". Each position sees different information and pursues different objectives.

Sources of power: the board's four families

Family	Source	Definition (slide)	Rests on · how it grows	Limits · how it is lost	Look for in a case	2026 case examples
Positional (formal): from the role	**Legitimate**	Formal authority to control and use organizational resources, based on one's position in the structure.	Title, mandate, rules, policy; accepted as "the right to ask".	Works only within the role's scope; gets compliance, not commitment; erodes if used unfairly.	Reports to, approves, signs off, policy, decides.	Mission Control sets every minute and bans private conferences Strike p.4, 9; Kamla hires Gargi into L&D R&G p.1; the AXB captain commands p.2.
	Reward	Compliance from the ability to distribute rewards others value: financial (pay, raises, bonuses) and non-financial (recognition, promotions, interesting work).	Control of what others want, and their belief that you will deliver it.	Only as strong as the reward's value; turns relationships transactional.	Appraisal, promotion, praise, selection, plum assignments.	McGinley picks the wildcards and pairings McG p.2, 7; Kamla's praise and talk of a bigger role for Gargi R&G p.2, 5; Greg James allocates work and writes evaluations GJ p.10.
	Coercive	Depends on fear of the negative results of not complying (sanctions, control over basic needs).	The ability to punish, withhold or threaten.	Breeds resentment and resistance; compliance lasts only under watch; invites counter-power.	Reprimand, threat, "consequences", "take it or leave it".	Shepard's public reprimand; more work during insomnia Strike p.8, 12; the captain evaluates FOs, a career threat AXB p.5–6.
Personal: from the individual	**Expert**	Influence based on expertise, special skill or knowledge.	Competence that others lack and need; a visible track record.	Narrow to its domain; fades if others learn it or never see it.	Degrees, years, "only they know", technical judgment.	Only crew 3 knows life in weightlessness Strike p.4; Gibson's solar physics p.7; the captain's 10,848 hours AXB p.5; Henry and Dana's planning know-how HT p.13.

Family	Source	Definition (slide)	Rests on · how it grows	Limits · how it is lost	Look for in a case	2026 case examples
	Referent	Influence based on identification with a person who has desirable resources or personal traits.	Being liked, admired, seen as "one of us"; charisma; character.	Fragile: goes with trust; cannot be ordered or delegated.	Admired, role model, charisma, favourite, "one of us".	McGinley, "one of us" McG p.1; Gargi "endeared herself to everyone" R&G p.5; Igor's charisma HT p.5; Ashok, a role model GJ p.9.
Informational	**Information**	Possessing knowledge or information that others need.	Access to and control of information flows; gatekeeping.	Gone once shared or bypassed; hoarding destroys trust.	First to know, controls the data, copies vs consults, withholds.	Mission Control's instructions and tapes; the crew hides the vomiting Strike p.2, 7–8; McGinley's data and caddie intelligence McG p.6–8; the US group's e-mail threads GJ p.10.
Relational (network)	**Network**	Comes from strong relationships across departments, divisions and units; becoming central by networking and controlling important resources and information. Soga et al. (2022): "the new currency of hybrid work".	Centrality and brokerage (betweenness, S3); coalitions; ties to the powerful.	Needs constant upkeep; ties can turn against you.	Meets other heads, coalitions, allies, mentors, alumni.	Gargi with Kamla, Vikram, IT and the CEO R&G p.2–5; McGinley with Ferguson, the vice-captains and caddies McG p.9–11; Sasha's alumni list and Dav HT p.7, 9; the surgeons as crew allies Strike p.12.

Telling the sources apart (common slips)

- **Legitimate vs reward or coercive.** Legitimacy is the right to ask; reward and coercion are the means to enforce. A boss usually holds all three, so name each with its own evidence.
- **Expert vs informational.** Expertise is a capability that can't be handed over (Gibson's physics). Information is an asset that can be shared, copied or withheld (the telemetry, the hidden vomiting).
- **Referent vs relational.** Referent: people want to be like you or please you. Relational: you are connected and central. Gargi has both.
- **Relational vs informational.** Networks bring information. Credit the tie when the leverage is the relationship, and the information when it is the content.
- **Potential counts.** An unused source is still power: McGinley never used coercion, and the FO had procedural authority to take control but didn't use it.
- **Dependence creates counter-power.** When the strong side needs something only the weak side has (labour, expertise, entry to a contest), label it with the nearest source and say "counter-power from dependence".

How to answer "sources of power" questions

1. Name the **exact source** and its **family** (board terms).
2. Give the **evidence**: who did what, with the page.
3. State the **effect** on the other party: compliance, commitment or resistance.
4. Cover **both sides**, including counter-power.
5. Close with what each **lacks** and the **net balance**: combinations make people powerful or powerless.

> **Model line:** "*Coercive (positional)*: Shepard publicly reprimanded the crew for hiding Pogue's vomiting p.8; the crew complied but turned 'curt and querulous', compliance without commitment."

> **Power shifts to spot.** Ramesh loses informational and relational power as Gargi gains both R&G p.3–5. Crew 3 turns expert and informational power into a strike Strike p.13–14. McGinley wins with referent, expert and relational power despite no star prestige McG p.10. Henry and Dana's know-how plus MGI's need for an HBS student outweigh their lack of formal authority HT p.2, 7, 13.

Power maps of the 2026 cases (H/M/L, with evidence; "–" = not visible)

Actor	Legitimate	Reward	Coercive	Expert	Referent	Informational	Relational	Lacks · net
Mission Control Strike	H sets the schedule; policy p.4, 9	M feedback crews valued p.5	H reprimand; cuts exercise p.8, 10–12	M planning data p.9	L "common enemy"	H instructions, tapes p.2, 8	H NASA HQ, scientists p.2	Legitimacy in the crew's eyes; lived knowledge. Strong but resisted.
Crew 3 Strike	L (Carr inside the crew)	L	M counter-power: the strike p.13–14	H only they know weightlessness p.4, 7	L not "favorites" p.4	M control what the ground hears p.7–8	M cohesive; surgeons p.8, 12	Formal authority. Wins a reset through dependence.
Flight surgeons Strike	L "nonmedical duty" p.12	–	–	H medical	–	M crew health data	L "no place to blow the whistle" p.12	Expertise without position: ignored.
Kamla R&G	H VP HR; 60/40 reporting p.1, 4	H praise, GPTW role, bigger role p.3, 5	L none shown	M HR	M Gargi's role model	H knows plans first p.1–2	H the CEO p.2	Transparency. Powerful, losing Ramesh's trust.
Gargi R&G	L–M CSR mandate p.4	L	L	M–H Microsoft L&D; CSR budget p.2–3	H "endeared herself" p.5	H "very well informed" p.2	H Kamla, Vikram, IT, CEO p.2–5	Formal authority. Rising fast.
Ramesh R&G	M head of L&D, 40% of Gargi p.1, 4	M over his team	L	H 15+ years in HR p.1	M team loyalty, now slipping p.4	L hears from outsiders p.3–4	L–M no strategic ties p.3	Information and network. Shrinking.
AXB captain AXB	H pilot in command p.2	H evaluates FOs p.5–6	H career threat to FOs	H 10,848 hours p.5	M seniority, ex-military	M	–	Dominant: a steep authority gradient.

Actor	Legitimate	Reward	Coercive	Expert	Referent	Informational	Relational	Lacks · net
AXB FO AXB	**M** SOP lets him take control p.2, 5	–	–	**M** correct call-outs p.3–4	**L**	**H** saw the unstable approach	**L** FOs defer to captains p.8	Held the key information, didn't use his authority.
McGinley McG	**H** captain p.2–3	**H** pairings, playing time p.7, 13	**L** unused	**H** data; five Ryder Cups p.3, 6–7	**H** "one of us" p.1	**H** data, caddie intelligence p.6–8	**H** Ferguson, VCs, caddies p.9–11	Star prestige p.10. Power without coercion.
Sasha HT	**H** founder p.2	**M** jobs "if things work out" p.6	**L**	**M** business, HBS MBA p.5	**L** with students; **H** with Igor p.4, 6	**M** company facts p.6	**H** alumni, investors, Dav p.4, 7, 9	Referent power with the students.
Henry and Dana HT	**L** no formal role p.13	**L**	**L**	**H** plan-writing, contest know-how p.13	**M** Henry's calm p.12	**H** research, slides p.9, 12	**M** each other, Igor	Authority; counter-power: the HBS-student rule p.2, 7.
Greg James GJ	**H** global manager of 45 p.8	**H** work, evaluations p.9–10	**M** feared evaluations p.10	**H** technical star p.5	**L** outside the US p.10	**M** US-first threads p.10	**M** Lawry; US group p.3	Referent power abroad.
Rahul Ashok GJ	**M** India service manager p.1	–	–	**H** 8 years, 7 in Santa Clara p.9	**H** role model p.9	**M**	**M** heir to Asia-Pacific p.9	UAE resists his rise p.10.
Chamanlal Asian Toys	**H** Chairman, final call p.1, 3	–	–	**L–M**	**M–H** founder's grandson p.1	**M** first to hear p.2	**M** convenes the executives p.3	Must use power fast and openly.

Pfeffer (2010) "Power Play": acquiring real clout needs bare-knuckle strategies

Core idea. Any strategy worth pursuing has opponents with a counter-agenda, so logic alone won't carry it; you need power. Start by knowing the resources you control. Money is only one: a network or access to information can be meted out or denied for leverage.

Make your peace with power. Power-motivated managers were the most effective (McClelland & Burnham), and political skill predicts effectiveness (Ferris's 18-item PSI). Zia Yusuf (SAP): you need substantive knowledge (what to do) *and* political skill (how to get it done). Flatter organizations need more influence, not less. Power and job control even predict a longer life (Marmot's civil servants).

Three barriers: (1) belief in a **just world** (do good work and things take care of themselves, so you miss the land mines); (2) the **leadership literature** (authentic, modest prescriptions that skip the power plays); (3) **delicate self-esteem** (self-handicapping: not trying, so failure doesn't hurt). In the cases: Ramesh shows all three; Gargi uses moves 3, 4, 8, 10 and 11.

The exercise of power: 11 moves	Example
1 Mete out resources (money, space, information, access)	Klaus Schwab decides who attends Davos.
2 Shape behaviour through rewards and punishments	John Gardner; reporters barred or sent gift baskets.
3 Advance on multiple fronts	Laura Esserman built national ties while blocked locally.
4 Make the first move	Lalit Modi and Sharad Pawar surprised Dalmiya at BCCI.
5 Co-opt antagonists	Univ. of Illinois gave protesters a women's committee.
6 Remove rivals, nicely if possible	Willie Brown helped rivals win seats elsewhere.
7 Don't draw unnecessary fire	Esserman's testimony was a mistake; Yusuf "lived to fight another day".
8 Use the personal touch	Jack Valenti met staffers in person, returned calls.
9 Persist	Esserman: "Yes, dear" (Richard Blum).
10 Make important relationships work, no matter what	Gary Loveman courted Harrah's resentful CFO.
11 Make the vision compelling	Robert Moses: "on the side of the parks... the angels"; invoke shareholders.

S7 · Exerting Influence (and Status)

Case: Paul McGinley. Reading: "Tactics of Influence: Three Ways to Project Influence" (HBS Essentials, ch. 4). Slides: Fiske et al. (2016); Kipnis et al. (1980); Lee et al. (2017); Djurdjevic et al. (2017).

Levers of influence: power, status (respect, prominence, prestige), and the tactics you use.

Influence tactic (Kipnis; Lee et al.)	Meaning
Rationality	Data and logical argument
Exchange	Offer something in return
Inspirational appeal	Appeal to values and ideals; build the target's confidence
Pressure	Demands, threats, continual checking
Legitimating	Establish the request's appropriateness or authority
Coalitions	Get others' help to influence the target
Ingratiation	Flattery or compliments
Consultation	Seek participation in the activity you want support for
Personal appeals	Friendship or loyalty
Apprising	Explain how support benefits the target's career
Collaboration	Provide resources if the target carries out the request

Status = the extent to which an individual or group is respected, regarded or admired by others ("How highly are you regarded?"). Harsanyi: apart from economic payoffs, status is the most important motivator of social behaviour. Status shifts, and is reinforced by race, class and gender status-competence beliefs.

Core aspects of workplace status: **respect** (valued attributes and accomplishments), **prominence** (standing out, receiving attention), **prestige** (deference for qualities that drive success: competence, commitment, leadership).

PUSH: raise my status relative to others	PULL: elevate others' status
Asserting dominance, competing, exclusion, criticism	Collaboration, supporting, inclusion, complimenting, listening and following up

Takeaways: everyone has multiple levers; the *willingness* to use status, power and tactics makes you powerful or powerless; tactics are neither good nor bad; the outcome sought gives them their valence.

Reading: three ways to project influence. (1) Framing: a frame is the mental window through which we view a problem; "establishing the framework... is often tantamount to determining the result" (Pfeffer). David reframed a marginal-NPV publishing project as a beachhead into a direct-sales market (the Normandy analogy). **(2) Information**: compelling, irrefutable facts; a citizen showed the golf course only broke even (half its costs hidden in the general fund) and the expansion died. **(3) Technical authority**: complexity makes leaders depend on experts (George, the MBA, steering two "techno-geek" owners).

S8 · Managing Difficult Interpersonal Conversations

Readings: "Mastering Difficult Conversations" (Stone & Hering interview, Rotman 2020); Brett & Goldberg (2017) "How to Handle a Disagreement on Your Team". Slides: Minson (2026) on receptiveness; HEAR.

Before the conversation (slide): What happened, in your story and in theirs? Understand the emotions. What's at stake? Check your purpose: should you raise it at all?

Disagreement. Trying to win an argument is a good way to start a fight. A **constructive disagreement** is any disagreement that increases willingness to talk to each other again. **Naïve realism**: we think we are accurate and objective and attribute the other side's view to lack of information or intelligence. Persuading is a losing battle; ask what information you may be missing and how a smart, reasonable, kind person could see it differently.

Receptiveness: willingness to access, consider and evaluate supporting and opposing views impartially (be in the presence of opposing ideas, attend to their arguments, scrutinize your own side equally). Components: emotional equanimity, intellectual curiosity, respect for opponents, tolerance of taboo issues. It is *not* compromising or changing your mind.

Listening triangle: ask a question → listen to the answer → acknowledge and reflect → ask again. People assume they understand others when they don't; practise on trivial topics first.

H · Hedge your claims	E · Emphasize agreement	A · Acknowledge other perspectives	R · Reframe to the positive
"I think it's possible that..."; "This might happen because..."; "Some people tend to think..."	"I think we both want to..."; "I agree with some of what you're saying"; "We are both concerned with..."	"I understand that..."; "I see your point"; "What I think you are saying is..."	"I think it's great when..."; "I really appreciate it when..."; "It would be so wonderful if..."

During: stay focused on goals; show receptiveness (listening triangle + HEAR); avoid explanatory words; share the personal story behind your belief and a little vulnerability (it doesn't sound like lecturing). **Build receptiveness**: surround yourself with receptive people and reward effort; create processes that build habits; start early in life; practise with AI coaches (no real conflict; they can argue any side).

Stone & Hering: the three conversations inside every difficult conversation

	Difficult (message-delivery) stance	Learning-conversation stance
"What happened?" (who's right, who meant what, who's to blame)	Whose story is right? It's either/or. They meant to have this impact. This is their fault.	Why do we see it differently; what are each of our data and reasoning? I don't like the impact, so I'll ask what they intended. We each contributed; let's find contributions and fix it.
Feelings	My feelings are their fault; either let them have it or keep quiet.	Share feelings without blame; acknowledge theirs with empathy without conceding their story.
Identity (what this says about me: competent? good?)	They're attacking my identity unfairly!	Part of what they say may make painful sense. What am I afraid of? Both stories can be valid without negating either of us.

Key moves. Decide whether to raise it by weighing short-term costs against the long-term costs of not raising it (concerns fester). **Separate intent from impact**: describe the impact on you and be curious about what they intended. Turn it into a **learning conversation**: understand their view, explain yours, understand feelings and impact, problem-solve together. Conversations fail when you open with your own perspective (implied judgment → defensiveness); open with the **"third story"**, a neutral description of the difference. Listen with open questions, paraphrase, don't cross-examine; express yourself without "you always/never". **Name and acknowledge emotions**. Self-awareness: if the same feedback comes 2–3 times, it is probably a blind spot.

Checklist (5 steps). 1 Prepare by walking through the three conversations (where does your story come from; impact; their intentions; your contribution; emotions; what's at stake for your identity). 2 Check your purpose and decide whether to raise it. 3 Start from the third story and invite them as a partner. 4 Explore their story and yours (listen, acknowledge, paraphrase; share your view; reframe truth → perceptions, blame → contribution, accusations → feelings). 5 Problem-solve (options that meet each side's key concerns; standards; mutual caretaking; keep communication open).

Brett & Goldberg: when two team members disagree, mediate rather than dictate

Why mediate	People own and implement decisions they helped make; dictating teaches nothing and makes them dependent on you. Impose only for major policy issues, imminent danger, or after all else fails.
Separate or joint first?	Separate first lets the angry person vent and the intimidated one feel heard and surfaces hidden information; joint first allows controlled venting but can escalate. Research: **start separately, build empathy, then move to joint**. Use **empathy** ("that must have been hard"), not sympathy ("I feel sorry for you").
First meeting	Explain your role (help them find a mutually acceptable resolution that works for the team too); acceptability requires their buy-in and yours; ground rules (respect, no interrupting). Goal: emotions abated, each feels respected by you.

Draw out	**Positions** (what each wants), **interests** (why), **priorities** (what matters more or less). Ask "why?/why not?", listen, reformulate so the other hears it.
Pitfalls	**Facts** arguments (each remembers differently → agree to disagree), **rights** arguments (fairness, precedent → park and gather information), **power** arguments (threats → restate ground rules).
Reaching agreement	Future-based agreements on how to interact; if trust is low: **limited duration** (trial, then review), **contingent** (switches if an event happens), **non-precedent-setting**. Ask each to propose solutions meeting the other's interests; if stuck, ask "what happens if you don't agree?"; finally impose, explain the reasoning, and give feedback for next time.

S9 · Understanding Team Roles and Styles

Slides: Belbin team roles. Reading: Vickberg & Christfort (2017) "The New Science of Team Chemistry" (with Helen Fisher interview).

Team role = "a tendency to behave, contribute and interrelate with others in a particular way". Roles develop with experience and conscious attention; used consciously they improve team functioning. Each of the nine roles has a typical strength and a characteristic weakness.

Role	Contribution · as a person	Allowable weaknesses	Non-allowable weaknesses
People-oriented roles			
Co-ordinator (CO)	Organizes the team, clarifies goals, promotes decisions, good chair, delegates. Mature, calm, self-confident, listens, fair, quietly charismatic.	Delegates personal work; can be seen as manipulative.	Takes personal credit for the team's effort; laziness.
Team worker (TW)	Counsellor and conciliator; improves communication; diffuses conflict; builds on suggestions. Social, mild, likeable, perceptive.	Indecisive; ostentatious; competes for status.	Avoids pressure situations; never gives an opinion.
Resource investigator (RI)	Develops outside contacts, explores opportunities, "fixer". Enthusiastic, extrovert, curious, good under pressure.	Relaxes when pressure is off; loses interest; over-optimistic; poor follow-through.	Neglects follow-up; lets people down.
Thinking roles			
Plant (PL)	Source of ideas; imagination; strategic issues. Individualistic, intellectual, unorthodox, creative.	"Up in the clouds"; ignores practical details; often frustrated.	Strong ownership of ideas; looks down on others; impatient.
Monitor evaluator (ME)	Judges options and feasibility; critical thinking; stops unsound ideas. Sober, strategic, sceptical, slow but steady.	Lacks drive; overly critical; "punch-ups" with Plants.	Constant harsh criticism; ignores feelings; stops progress; cynicism.
Specialist (SP)	"The expert"; knowledge in short supply. Dedicated, single-minded, loner.	Too technical; theoretical.	Won't engage in broader team issues ("not my problem").
Action-oriented roles			
Shaper (SH)	Gives direction, sets objectives, challenges inertia and complacency. Outgoing, dynamic, driven, courageous.	Argumentative, provocative, prone to irritation.	Tramples on feelings; can't recover with humour or apology; bullying.
Implementer (IM)	Turns plans into practical action; organizing; "workhorse". Disciplined, reliable, conservative, methodical.	Inflexible; unresponsive to new ideas.	Obstructs change; unwilling to adapt.
Completer-finisher (CF)	Quality control, attention to detail, sense of urgency, stops omissions. Conscientious, orderly, anxious.	Worries; perfectionism; reluctant to delegate.	Obsessive; negative thinking; demotivating nit-picking.

Using Belbin. Each person has natural, manageable and least-preferred roles; play to natural roles and let others fill your weakest. Everyone can switch among 4–6 roles; beware labelling. **Unbalanced teams**: shared weaknesses become the team's weakness; shared strengths make people compete. Too many **Plants** → all brainstorming, no action; too many **MEs** → analysis paralysis; too many **Shapers** → conflict. Keep allowable weaknesses from becoming non-allowable (a Plant drifting off in a meeting is OK; forgetting the meeting is not). Roles present ≠ quality outcome.

Business Chemistry (Deloitte): four work styles. Pioneers value possibilities; spark energy and imagination; take risks, big picture, go with their gut (outgoing, spontaneous, adaptable, imaginative). **Guardians** value stability; bring order and rigour; risk-averse; data, detail, learn from the past (methodical, reserved, structured, loyal). **Drivers** value challenge; generate momentum; results and winning; logical, direct, black-and-white (quantitative, focused, competitive, experimental). **Integrators** value connection; draw teams together; diplomatic, consensus-seeking, relationship-oriented (empathic, non-confrontational). **Opposites**: Pioneer ↔ Guardian, Driver ↔ Integrator.

Style	Energized by	Alienated by	To draw them out
Pioneer	Brainstorming; spontaneity and trying new things; enthusiasm	Rules and structure; the word "no"; a focus on process	Room for expansive discussion, whiteboards; time-box it.
Guardian	Organization; predictability and consistency; a detailed plan	Disorder; time pressure; ambiguity and uncertainty	Time and details to prepare; let them contribute in writing.
Driver	Solving problems; directness; winning	Indecision; inefficiency; lack of focus	Brisk pace, link to goal; experimentation or competition.
Integrator	Collaboration; communication; trust and respect	Politics; conflict; inflexibility	Build a relationship first; ask about the greater good; do some of it offline.

Managing the styles: (1) **Pull your opposites closer** (start them on small joint projects; productive friction like Lennon and McCartney). (2) **Elevate the "tokens"**: lopsided teams suffer *cascades* (reputational: fear of looking bad; informational: assuming early speakers know more) → groupthink; ask minority styles to speak early (Asch: one dissenter frees others), brainstorm individually then share round-robin, ask people to "think like a Guardian". (3) **Pay attention to sensitive introverts** (Guardians and "Quiet Integrators" report the most stress; give preparation time, solo work, light-touch direct asks, celebrate good-faith failures). Most top leaders are Pioneers or Drivers, the most vocal styles. **Helen Fisher**: four brain systems: dopamine (curious, creative, risk-taking) · serotonin (traditional, rule-following, belonging) · testosterone (direct, decisive, analytical) · estrogen/oxytocin (intuitive, empathetic, verbal). Complementary styles make a team effective.

S10 · Teams and Cross-Cultural Challenges

Case: Henry Tam and the MGI Team. Reading: Brett, Behfar & Kern (2006) "Managing Multicultural Teams". Slides: Mathieu et al. (2019); Tuckman (1965); Gersick (1988).

Team (Mathieu et al. 2019): (a) two or more individuals who (b) socially interact, face-to-face or virtually, (c) have one or more common goals, (d) are brought together for organizationally relevant tasks, (e) are interdependent in workflow, goals and outcomes, (f) have different roles and responsibilities, (g) are embedded in a wider organizational system with boundaries and links.

Teams then: stable and single membership, shared goals, defined roles, common location, defined tasks. **Teams now**: fluid and multiple membership, swift teams, virtual location, ambiguous tasks and responsibilities (Tannenbaum et al. 2011).

Tuckman stage	What you see
Forming	Orientation; getting acquainted, learning skill sets; discussing team and individual goals, roles, ground rules, timelines.
Storming	Conflicts (personality, working styles); factions and cliques; some feel left out.
Norming	Norms develop; idiosyncrasies accepted; "we" feeling, cohesiveness.
Performing	High cohesion and trust; efficiency; clear processes for resolving issues.
Adjourning	Task done, team breaks up; anxiety, sadness; leader evaluates lessons.

Punctuated equilibrium (Gersick 1988): groups stay static for long periods with incremental change; revolutionary change happens in brief bursts (groups cycle between storming and performing), typically around the **midpoint**; these transition windows are opportunities for innovation and for resetting norms.

Brett, Behfar & Kern: four challenges of multicultural teams

Direct vs indirect communication	Western communication is explicit; elsewhere meaning is embedded in context. An American's direct e-mail about system flaws embarrassed her Japanese colleagues, who isolated her (office moved to a storage room). Indirect alternative: ask "what would happen if...".
Trouble with accents and fluency	Non-fluent members' expertise goes unused and they are seen as less competent (the US consultant led the interviews; the Japanese consultants were dismissed as not intelligent enough).
Differing attitudes to hierarchy and authority	Teams are flat by design. A humble Mexican manager phrasing answers as questions seemed unsure; Americans complaining to senior Korean managers nearly wrecked a deal.
Conflicting decision-making norms	Speed and analysis differ (Koreans re-opened points 1–3; Americans wanted point 4). Make minor process concessions; keep impatient bosses away; say "we need the big picture first".

Strategy	Representative problems	Enabling conditions	Complicating factors	Example
Adaptation (acknowledge cultural gaps openly and work around them; ideal)	Conflict from decision-making differences; misunderstanding or stonewalling from communication differences.	Members attribute the challenge to culture, not personality; higher managers unavailable, or involving them would embarrass the team.	Members must be very aware; negotiating common understanding takes time.	American engineer adapted to Israelis' argumentative style; US–UK "fusion" decision process; call-centre team rescued a chatty colleague's calls.
Structural intervention (reorganize to reduce friction)	Emotional tension over fluency or prejudice; members inhibited by perceived status differences.	The team can be subdivided to mix cultures or expertise; tasks can be subdivided.	Badly mixed subgroups harden differences; subgroup solutions must fit back together.	Leader hired a consultant to run meetings because members "shut down" when he spoke; rotating mixed small groups for Japanese female consultants.
Managerial intervention (set norms early or bring in a higher manager)	Violations of hierarchy causing loss of face; no ground rules causing conflict.	High emotion; stalemate; a higher manager able and willing to intervene.	Team becomes dependent on the manager; members sidelined or resistant.	Manager told accented engineers they were chosen for expertise and to say "If you don't understand me, stop me"; China refinery issues escalated through matched hierarchies.
Exit (voluntary or involuntary removal; last resort)	A member can't adjust and can no longer contribute.	Team is permanent; emotions beyond intervention; too much face lost.	Talent and training costs lost.	Greek consultant left after a feud with a Polish colleague.

Wrong managerial intervention can make the team dependent (the US–India software project where the manager ended up deciding minute details and the project careened off schedule). Cultivate cultural intelligence: read cues, adopt habits of the other culture, build confidence.

S11 · Virtual Team Challenges (and Types of Conflict)

Case: Greg James at Sun Microsystems (A). Readings: Ferrazzi (2014) "Getting Virtual Teams Right"; Mortensen & Haas (2021) "Making the Hybrid Workplace Fair"; Dinh et al. (2021) "Developing team trust". Slides: Allen curve; Monalisa et al. (2008); Gallo (2017); De Wit et al. (2012).

Virtual (geographically dispersed) team: works across time, space and organizational boundaries, linked by communication technology. **Allen curve**: communication falls steeply with distance (next door: weekly contact likely; same aisle: rare; another floor or country: slim chance). **Virtual team issues**: trust · communication · conflict · accountability · skills.

Conflict type	Definition · examples · effect
Task	Disagreement over the *goal* or what you are trying to achieve (meeting agenda, how to measure success, revenue vs customer satisfaction). **Positively** associated with decision quality and commitment (Amason 1996), in moderation.
Relationship	Clash of personalities; feeling disrespected or hurt (snapping in meetings, snarky e-mails, interrupting, arguing over who's right). **Negative** for decision quality, satisfaction, commitment.
Status	Disputes over relative positions in the group's hierarchy: who's in charge, who gets credit (competing for high-profile projects, resources, status symbols, jockeying for leadership). **Negative** for performance (Bendersky & Hays 2012).
Process	*How* to do the work: means, decision method, speed, who to consult. **Negative** for performance (Jehn & Mannix 2001).

Ferrazzi: four must-haves for virtual teams. Right team: people with communication skills, emotional intelligence, independence, resilience, cultural sensitivity; **size under 10** (worst performers had 13+ members; social loafing starts beyond 4–5; Hackman: 10 conversations for everyone to connect on a team of 5 vs 78 on a team of 13); roles in tiers (core, operational, outer: Ancona's X-team). **Right leadership**: foster trust (share backgrounds; video tours; 5 minutes of personal news on calls); encourage open dialogue ("caring criticism"; appoint a candor advocate); clarify goals and guidelines (response times, specific requests, follow-up e-mails); ban multitasking, use video. **Right touchpoints**: face-to-face **kickoff** (swift trust; small wins for dissimilar pairs), real **onboarding** (in-person welcome, mentor), **milestones** (meet to celebrate or crack tough problems; at least quarterly). **Right technology**: conference calling that records and transcribes, plus video; direct calling and texting; discussion forums or virtual team rooms ("working out loud"). *Stats*: 79% work in dispersed teams; 82% of 70 virtual teams missed goals (Govindarajan & Gupta); well-managed dispersed teams can outperform co-located ones.

Virtual distance (Lojeski & Reilly): **physical** (geography, time, different units), **operational** (team size, other commitments, little face-to-face, technical skills), **affinity** (culture, rank, interdependence, prior relationships). High virtual distance → trust −83%, innovation −93%, satisfaction −80%, performance −50%.

Mortensen & Haas: making the hybrid workplace fair. Hybridity creates power differentials from two sources. **Hybridity positioning**: *resource access* (in-office people get technology, current and informal "water-cooler" information, social support) and *visibility* (being seen by those in power → staffing, credit). **Hybridity competence**: skill at relationship-building in both modes, claiming resources, political awareness, flexibility, showing trustworthiness under low visibility. Manager actions: **track and communicate** (map who works where and when); **design** (redistribute access and visibility; fix KPIs and evaluations); **educate** (bias; psychological safety and trust); **monitor** key moments: performance reviews, team launches, onboarding.

Dinh et al. (2021): developing team trust in virtual settings. Trust is a dynamic, shared, subjective state. **Cognitive trust** (reliability, competence; built over time) via: (1) outline shared goals, benefits and risks (regular check-ins; values beyond metrics); (2) set clear boundaries and team norms (flexible availability; formal and informal onboarding; set expectations together); (3) monitor engagement (manage emotions; avoid "Zoom fatigue"; unobtrusive check-ins); (4) identify and maintain clear roles. **Affective trust** (familiarity, care) via: (5) an inclusive community through psychological safety (shared circumstances; praise; low-stakes exchanges); (6) commitment to the organization (show investment in people, resources, empowering leadership); (7) connecting outside work (virtual coffee; personal milestones); (8) collaboration and contingencies (backup behaviour, keep everyone in the loop, clear "second in command").

S12–13 · Group Decision Making and Team Process

Reading: Hill & Farkas (2001) "A Note on Team Process". Slides: synergy and process losses. Board: team decision-making exercise.

Actual productivity = potential productivity + synergy – process losses. Synergy = the team does better than any individual member. Leaders must raise synergy and cut process losses. Board version: **TF = Potential + Synergies – Process losses** (→ conformity, loss of participation).

Process-loss category	Forms and signals
Conformity	**Groupthink**: overlooking problems in pursuit of consensus. **Abilene paradox**: a decision contrary to what each member believes, because nobody wants to "rock the boat"; not voicing concerns about a wrong or risky decision.
Participation	Who contributes and why (age, experience, competence, style). **Social loafing** (less effort in a group; "others are slacking"). **Bystander effect** (diffusion of responsibility). The most frequently stated ideas get adopted regardless of quality.
Decision-making biases	**Common knowledge effect**: time spent on information everyone already has instead of unique knowledge. Fix: map expertise ("what do *you* know that I don't?"), suspend judgment, don't rely only on majority rule, redirect to unshared information, include someone who signals differences. Also rushing to the first solution backed by opinion leaders.
Conflict	Who is listened to, who is ignored, rivalry, people who always disagree: **creative abrasion or personal abrasion**?
Influence (Note)	Influence follows status, loudness or rank rather than expertise; minority views ignored.

Decision rules: majority, minority, voting, consensus, qualified consensus.

Decrease process losses: spend early time on goals, rules and responsibilities; develop decision rules; group monitoring; identify experts; use conflict appropriately. **Solutions**: contracts; build trust through shared activities and self-disclosure.

Where synergy comes from: integrating diverse information; buy-in (motivational pull); de-biasing.

Future of teams (Mortensen & Haas 2018): **fluid** (members change with work demands), **overlap** (people on several teams), **dispersion** (geographic or organizational).

Board: what the teams did in the decision exercise. 1 Decided quickly vs talked and sought more information; 2 fixated (anchored on a "neutral" item); 3 democratic (everyone voiced, took decisions together, but time ran short); 4 competence (who really knew); 5 goal clarity; 6 lack of a contrarian; 7 inability to listen; 8 **advocacy vs inquiry** balance (dismissive jokes kill inquiry); 9 logical/rational argument. **Scoring legend** (error scores, lower is better): High = worst member's score; Low = best member's; Avg = members' average; TES = team error score; **TF = High − TES** (team functioning: better than the worst); **TSy = Avg − TES** (synergy: positive means the team beat its average member); **TI = Low − TES** (team beat even its best member if positive); "# ≤ 4" = members who did as well as or better than the team. Negative TSy (teams 4, 5, 8 and 13) = **process loss**.

A Note on Team Process (Hill): four aspects of process every member can influence

Decision-making	Avoid being solution-minded (groups adopt the first solution backed by opinion leaders). Four steps: (1) identify and explore the problem (symptoms vs causes; challenge assumptions; collect data); (2) generate possible solutions in a psychologically safe atmosphere (brainstorming, nominal group technique); (3) refine and critique; aim for consensus (agreement everyone can accept even if not their first choice) and keep conflict constructive; (4) implement (assign tasks and owners).
Participation	Easiest to observe. Imbalance matters because the most frequently stated ideas get adopted; low participators disengage. Diagnose: who is high or low and why, shifts, how silence is read, who talks to whom. Intervene as **gatekeeper**: "Tom, let me check I understood your point", "Jamal, you haven't spoken; what do you think?". Styles differ (e.g., women on average wait longer for a pause).
Influence	Not the same as participation. Dangerous when the most influential are the highest-ranking or loudest rather than the most expert. Diagnose: who is listened to or ignored, rivalry, who interrupts whom, minority views. Intervene: support neglected views ("we're not giving Andrea's point enough thought"), name domination, broaden the discussion.
Conflict	Need **task conflict** (creative abrasion) and little **affective/interpersonal conflict**; too little task conflict = **groupthink** (worse with homogeneity and time pressure). Members ask "Am I accepted? Do I have value? Do I have influence?", so they take task conflict personally. Remedies: clear behaviour rules, ground debate in data, generate several alternatives, share power for fairness, common goals; devil's advocate; outsiders; "we agree a lot; have we tackled the tough issues?"

Team development (Note). Getting started: size 5–10; technical, conceptual and interpersonal competencies; include stakeholders; build commitment and inclusion (avoid in/out-groups; cognitive diversity helps but slows early process); leadership (self-managed teams without a known leader perform worse). **Getting to work**: demanding, measurable performance goals (purpose is imposed, goals are built in the team); agreed working approach (logistics, roles, quick wins, fair share); prevent **social loafing** (personal accountability, meaningful tasks for all); shape culture via explicit norms on power, communication, legitimate topics and conflict. **Monitoring**: self-examination every few meetings; **manage the midpoint** (punctuated equilibrium; reset norms, bring outside eyes); evaluate on **perform, satisfy, adapt**.

Global and virtual teams (Note). Creative tasks gain most from demographic diversity; computational a little; coordinative tasks least, and may suffer. "Internationalists" ease it. Differences in demeanour (eye contact, interruptions, punctuality) → stereotyping and affective conflict; a few national blocs → coalitions along national lines; many single nationalities → own identity. Virtual: trust harder (judged on integrity, ability, benevolence), so share bios early and never assume unstated understandings; high-context cultures need richer media. **Hallmarks of effective team process**: clear performance goals · maximum use of talents and views · diversity with integration · mutual accountability · purposeful, rigorous decisions · conflict-resolution processes · self-examination for continuous learning.

S14 · Diversity in Teams

Reading: Slater, Weigand & Zwirlein (2008) "The Business Case for Commitment to Diversity". Slides: Robbins; Harrison, Price & Bell (1998).

Diversity = "the condition of having or being composed of differing elements" (Merriam-Webster); the extent to which group members are similar to or different from one another (Robbins). **Why it matters**: *moral* (fairness, responsibilities, overcoming historical inequalities) and *business* (innovation and creativity, better decisions, access to talent, market understanding, reputation).

Surface-level diversity	Deep-level diversity
Observable demographic and physical attributes: age, gender, ethnicity, nationality, language. Immediate impact; shapes first impressions; key for representation and compliance.	Values, beliefs, attitudes, personality, cognitive style (and functional/ educational background, tenure). Invisible at first, emerges over time; drives innovation, problem-solving, adaptability; shapes team process and performance.

Inclusion policies must address both: surface (equal opportunity, bias mitigation) and deep (valuing cognitive and value-based diversity).

Inclusion is…	Inclusion is not…
Sharing ideas from all perspectives; valuing people *because of* their differences; working together despite differences; celebrating differences of thought.	The delusion that everyone will always get along; pretending to agree to avoid conflict; ignoring differences.

Diversity	Inclusion
Achieved by hiring different people · an outcome · a technical, complicated problem	Achieved by changing mind-sets · a process · an adaptive, complex problem

Slater et al. (2008). Commitment to diversity (CEO commitment, human capital, internal and external corporate communications, supplier diversity) is an "invisible asset". In resource-based terms (Barney) it is valuable, rare, hard to imitate (socially complex culture) and non-substitutable. **Three routes to advantage**: (1) **decision quality** (diverse boards and top teams; Hamel's diverse voices in strategy; customer orientation pays only with diverse top teams); (2) **connecting with customers** (P&G's "first moment of truth"; Pepsi: half of new hires women or minorities; employee–customer similarity cuts communication costs); (3) **innovating** (Indra Nooyi; IDEO; minority opinions spark divergent thinking). **Costs**: harder communication, lower cohesion, higher turnover, less cooperation, resentment, minorities feeling exploited, so most studies find weak or no direct link. **Evidence**: DiversityInc Top 50 (2004) vs matched firms, 1998–2003: higher median net profit margin every year (about +2.7 pts a year on average), higher ROA every year and higher ROE (+2.5–6 pts). 2006 Top 50 public firms beat the S&P 500 by 24.8% over 10 years. **Lessons**: tie diversity to strategy (a tailored business case); line management, not HR, owns it, with visible CEO commitment (IBM's eight task forces); set targets and metrics (Chrysler supplier target 7% → 8%); treat human capital as advantage (Dell); recruit early (Marriott internships); team-building and group-process training; reach multicultural markets; diverse suppliers; emphasize fairness to prevent backlash; prepare for conflict (avoid it early in creative work, encourage it mid-stage). Diversity as a "programme" costs more than it gives; as a cultural commitment it pays.

S15 · Managing Teams in Crisis

Case: Asian Toys (role play). Reading: Katzenbach (1997) "The Myth of the Top Management Team". Slides: Pearson & Clair (1998); James et al. (2011); Bundy et al. (2017); Weiner (2006).

A business crisis involves: ambiguity (of cause, effect or means of resolution), high stakes, perceived urgency, rarity, significance for the firm's health, impact on stakeholders.

	Pre-crisis prevention	Crisis management	Post-crisis outcomes
Internal	Organizational preparedness (culture, design, structure to prevent breakdowns)	Crisis leadership	Organizational learning (are lessons internalized?)
External	Stakeholder relationships	Stakeholder perceptions (understand and manage them)	Social evaluations (response must match stakeholders' attribution of responsibility)

Bundy, Pfarrer, Short & Coombs (2017).

Psychology of crisis leadership: "holding". In a crisis people don't need a vision (they are already raring to act); they need leaders who acknowledge their emotions, contain distress and give context and reality, so the urge to act becomes purposeful. "People never forget how managers treated them when they were facing loss."

Media in a crisis: Do	Don't
Prepare for interviews	Repeat loaded words ("crisis", "devastating")
Develop key messages and facts about the incident and steps taken	Speculate; say what you know and commit to disclose more
Anticipate questions; keep answers short	Go "off the record"
Respect deadlines; provide written information	Use jargon; lose your temper
Be positive but show empathy for those affected	Say "no comment"; tell what you know
Make yourself accessible	Try to stop a journalist from writing a story

Katzenbach: "The Myth of the Top Management Team"

Real team = "a small number of people with complementary skills who are committed to a common purpose, performance goals, and an approach for which they hold themselves mutually accountable." The leadership group at the top seldom functions as a real team; it is usually a single-leader working group, and that's often fine.

Three myths: (1) teamwork at the top leads to team performance (teamwork, the "four Cs" of communication, cooperation, collaboration and compromise, is not team performance); (2) top teams should spend more time building consensus (real teams thrive on conflict; many decisions are better made individually); (3) the senior group should act as a team whenever it is together (most interactions aren't team opportunities).

Why non-team behaviour prevails: meaningful purpose hard to define at the top; tangible goals hard to set; the right skill mix is absent ("all my direct reports" fallacy, e.g., the $100M MIS consultant fiasco); heavy time commitment; real teams need mutual, not individual, accountability; non-teams fit the power structure ("power alley"); non-teams are fast and efficient.

Executive leadership discipline	Team discipline
Individual accountability	Mutual accountability for collective results
Broad strategy, policy, objectives	Tightly focused, specific performance goals

Executive leadership discipline	Team discipline
Creates urgency on critical issues	Mobilizes around a meaningful purpose
Decides alone with personal judgment	Collective judgment via dialogue, conflict resolution, real work
Assigns people by position	Members chosen for skills the task needs
Leverages time via efficient processes	Seldom the most efficient route

Three litmus tests for a real team: (1) **collective work-products** of clear value (not discussion or delegation; e.g., Citicorp credit redesign, Browning-Ferris refinancing); (2) **shifting leadership** to whoever has the relevant knowledge (BFI: CFO with the board, CEO with investors, COO internally); (3) **mutual accountability** ("we hold one another accountable").

When top teams make sense: major unexpected events such as mergers bring urgency, measurable imperatives, issues needing integrated skills, overlapping structures needing informal networks, and temporary leadership roles (Mobil's leadership-development team under Lucio Noto; Texas Instruments' calculator team). **Guidelines**: pick your shots wisely; consider your options; make three trade-offs consciously (time, skills over titles, leadership capacity); apply the discipline that fits; learn different leadership roles.

C · Case Evidence Banks

Each bank: snapshot → cast → timeline → ready-made classifications with evidence and page numbers of the original case PDF → action plan. Levels are defensible calls; the marking scheme accepts any level you defend with evidence.

C1 · Ramesh & Gargi (A) IIMA OB0216(A), Vohra & Pattnaik (2014) · Session 2

Snapshot. Chrysalis Pharmaceuticals, a multinational drug maker; India HQ in Chennai since 2009; four plants; 1,200 employees p.1. Culture: informal and self-driven (people plan their own schedules but informally tell the team and leader where they are) p.4. Ramesh, head of L&D, feels blindsided and sidelined by a new, high-energy recruit (Gargi) whom his boss (Kamla) brought into his team. After seven months he has lunch with another company's HR head and starts answering headhunters p.1, 5. **Core issues**: interpersonal relationships, P-G and P-S fit, trust, EVLN, networking, triangulated perceptions.

Person	Facts that matter
Ramesh Sharma	Head of L&D; Chrysalis's 5th employee, handpicked by the CEO and Kamla; 15+ years across all HR divisions at a 25,000-person oil company (rose to deputy HR head); XLRI PMIR; joined to "work for change" in an entrepreneurial culture; partnered Kamla on onboarding, training, career planning and HR policies p.1.
Gargi Sinha	Young TISS MBA; 3 years in L&D at Microsoft; moved to Chennai after her wedding; spotted by Kamla at a "women in industry" seminar; L&D plus CSR, reporting 60% to Kamla and Vikram (CSR) and 40% to Ramesh p.2, 4.
Kamla Saxena	VP HR, the 3rd employee; "reserved, no-nonsense, conservative", usually not effusive; Gargi became "her favorite" p.4.
Others	Raman Murthy (CEO); Vikram Agarwal (finance head, "notoriously hard-to-please") p.3; L&D team: Fiona (senior coordinator, 20 years), Debjeet and Saurabh (technical training), Naresh (medical-rep training); Abhinav Sood (marketing head) p.4.

#	Timeline (seven months)
1	**August, the elevator.** Kamla introduces Gargi as a new recruit for L&D; Ramesh had not asked for a team member and Kamla never mentioned it p.1. In his office Gargi "made herself comfortable", says D&I is "an area of requirement" (news to him) and leaves abruptly for a meeting she had set up with the finance and production heads p.2.
2	**Next day.** Kamla spends the whole meeting praising Gargi ("great catch"; Raman impressed) and asks him to "help realize Gargi's potential". He feels "punched in the stomach... blindsided" p.2.
3	**Next morning.** Gargi walks in unannounced: a virtual women's forum already approved by Kamla, IT engaged, Fiona has written content. Ramesh "had boarded the slow train while Gargi flew past on the express". He explains the team norm of discussing initiatives first; she agrees teams are valuable but says the forum is "not part of L&D" p.2.
4	**Weeks later.** Peers praise Gargi (Vikram jokes she'll help Ramesh understand the "cost" of L&D); the CEO credits L&D's D&I work at the executive committee and Kamla "beamed knowingly" p.3. Several D&I initiatives he learns about only at launch.
5	**Westside.** A former colleague praises him for a women's-leadership panel he knew nothing about; he covers ("It must have been Gargi's idea... very talented and a high performer") and drags his family home p.3. Gargi had copied him on the flyer in a general e-mail he hadn't opened; her pattern is to copy him and Kamla but never consult him, and his suggestions never make the final plan p.3.
6	**Talk with Kamla.** "Should I be involved?" "By all means." "Gargi doesn't often discuss these things with me." Kamla, rushing to a meeting: "Why don't you just sort it out with Gargi? Give her space and teach her about the culture of the place" p.3.
7	**Team drift.** Gargi keeps erratic hours (online at 4 am, missing by day), travels without telling him, and refuses to coordinate his senior-management event ("not part of her role"), yet wins his team's support. Fiona and Gargi lunch together; Fiona shuts down Naresh and Debjeet's complaints; Debjeet asks to come late or leave early; Naresh launches an initiative Ramesh hears of from the marketing head p.4.
8	**Vacation.** Kamla, who used to call several times, doesn't call once; his wife notes it was his lean period, he dismisses that p.4–5.
9	**Great Places to Work.** Gargi coordinates the survey on Kamla's recommendation; Chrysalis wins a D&I mention and "Most Promising New Entrant". Gargi attends the division heads' dinner, charms seniors, the CEO applauds her; Raman and Kamla ask her about expanding into other L&D areas. Ramesh leaves early without congratulating her and replies to headhunters p.5.

Board: the perception grid (each person's self-view vs how others see them)

	...seen by Ramesh	...seen by Gargi	...seen by Kamla
Ramesh	(class view) resistant to change, bureaucratic, team player, experienced, identity threat, declining sense of inclusion, insecure, low flexibility; approachable, dedicated, loyal	Insecure, controlling, process-oriented, rigid, slow, low openness to change; experienced, knowledgeable; avoidable; team player	Rigid, resistant, conventional; stable, insecure; team player
Gargi	Disrespectful, opportunistic, energetic, over-enthusiastic, charismatic	(self) Enthusiastic, extrovert, confident, competent, energetic, proactive, creative, hardworking, independent, autonomous, ambitious, diligent, go-getter, expressive, bold, trailblazer	Confident, dependable, hardworking, impressive, enthusiastic, proactive, competent, self-driven, ambitious
Kamla	Ambiguous, biased, conservative, triangulation, favouritism, unresponsive, lack of clear communication	Mentor-like, admirable, role model, approachable, visionary, trusting, dependable, supportive	(self) No-nonsense, empathetic, reserved, strategic, agile, decisive, work-oriented, unbiased; less transparent, result-oriented, independent

Use it for "perception/attribution" and "trust" answers: each person explains others' behaviour by traits ("opportunistic", "rigid") rather than by the situation (unclear dual reporting, no role charter).

Big Five

	Ramesh	Gargi	Kamla
O	**M**: left a bureaucratic oil major to "work for change… in an entrepreneurial culture" p.1, but uneasy with Gargi's pace and informality and insists new ideas go through team discussion p.2; Gargi and Kamla see him as rigid (board).	**H**: stream of new ideas (training women, D&I, wellness camps, virtual women's forum, leadership panel) p.2–3; "trailblazer" (board).	**M**: champions D&I and hired Gargi with "no immediate plans" for her p.2, yet "conservative" p.4.
C	**H**: process-oriented, plans collaboratively, built HR policies; 15-year track record p.1, 4. (Lapse: left her e-mail unopened for three days because it wasn't addressed to him p.3.)	**Split**: **H** achievement-striving (hardworking, focused, handles complex tasks; detailed CSR budget; GPTW legwork) p.3–5 but **L** dutifulness to team norms (erratic hours, travels without informing, misses L&D activities) p.4.	**H**: decisive, results-oriented, "no-nonsense" p.4; (rushes off having forgotten a meeting p.3).
E	**L–M**: "tentatively" raises the issue with Kamla, keeps a "poker face", can't explain his feelings to his wife, leaves the dinner early p.3, 5.	**H**: "ebullient… laughed easily and loudly… no inhibitions" p.2; connects easily with senior people at the dinner p.5.	**L**: "reserved… usually not very effusive" p.4.
A	**H**: praises Gargi to an outsider, congratulates her and offers help, avoids confrontation, values consensus p.2–3.	**L–M**: friendly and liked, but disregards Ramesh's input and norms and refuses his event as "not part of her role" p.3–4.	**M**: warm to Gargi; brushes off Ramesh's concern ("sort it out with Gargi") p.3.
N	**H**: "punched in the stomach", "blindsided", ruminates, feels left out on vacation and dismisses his wife's explanation, impulsively answers headhunters p.2, 4–5.	**L**: confident and at ease with seniors from day one p.2, 5.	**L**: calm, unruffled.

Fit (Kristof-Brown)

	Ramesh	Gargi
P-O	**M, declining from H**: drawn by Raman's vision and Kamla's energy, his "dream job" p.1; now out of step with the new speed, informality and D&I priorities and weighing exit p.5. Board: ✓.	**H**: informal, self-driven culture suits her; the CEO champions D&I; the GPTW recognition rests on her work p.4–5.
P-J	**H → M**: deep HR expertise; his team ran "like a well-oiled machine" p.4; but his department's flagship work bypasses him and Raman and Kamla discuss expanding Gargi's role into L&D p.5. Board: ✓.	**H**: the CSR/D&I role matches her passion and Microsoft L&D background p.2.
P-G	**L**: his team is splitting (Fiona aligned with Gargi; Debjeet and Naresh drifting) p.4; the consensus culture he built is eroding. Board: ×.	**M–L**: wins team members' support for her events and bonds with Fiona p.4, but ignores L&D norms; Naresh and Debjeet see her as not a team member p.4.
P-S	**L (was H)**: Kamla hired into his team without telling him p.1, dismissed his concern p.3, stopped calling on vacation p.4. Board: ×.	With Kamla **H** (mentor-like, favourite) p.4; with Ramesh **L** (never consults him) p.3; with Vikram **M** (praised her budget, privately noncommittal) p.3–4.

EVLN: Ramesh's options

Exit	Lunch with a retail company's HR head ("options to fall back on"); replies to headhunters p.1, 5.
Voice	Only tentative: explains team culture to Gargi p.2; "tentatively broaching" with Kamla p.3.
Loyalty	Covers for Gargi publicly, praises her, waits for things to improve p.3.
Neglect	Ignores general e-mails; walks out of the dinner without congratulating p.3, 5.

Board: use STRENGTHS (RBS) to move from neglect/exit to VOICE.

Conflict types

Relationship	Resentment: Ramesh sees Gargi as "disrespectful, opportunistic" (board); skips congratulating her p.5.
Task	What counts as L&D work: the women's forum is "not part of L&D" p.2; his event "not part of her role" p.4.
Process	Team-first consensus vs "running with the ball"; copying on e-mail vs consulting; keeping the team informed of whereabouts p.2–4.
Status	Credit and leadership of D&I/L&D: Gargi at the division heads' dinner and a possible role expansion into L&D p.5; Vikram's joke p.3.

Trust

Pair	Rating and evidence (Abrams: competence vs benevolence)
Ramesh ↔ Kamla	**Eroding (was H)**. Earlier both kinds: partners on HR policies, frequent meetings, she called him on vacation p.1, 4. Broken builders: #3 frequent, rich communication (didn't tell him about the hire p.1); #5 fair and transparent decisions (dual reporting, visible favouritism p.4); #2 word and deed ("By all means" without follow-through p.3); #6 shared vision (D&I agenda not shared p.2).
Ramesh ↔ Gargi	**Competence trust M**: he calls her "very talented and a high performer" p.3 and is impressed by her ease with seniors p.5. **Benevolence trust L**: she copies but never consults him and refused his event p.3–4. From her side he is "slow, rigid, avoidable" (board) → low.
Gargi ↔ Kamla	**H** both ways: Kamla recruited and praises her p.2; Gargi "liked Kamla very much" p.2, sees her as mentor and role model (board).

Networking, power, influence. Gargi is a strategic networker (Ibarra): she works with the boss's boss (Kamla, Raman), finance (Vikram), production, IT and division heads, plus external circles (the women-in-industry seminar, Microsoft): *leverage* through inside-outside links. Power: relational, referent ("endeared herself to everyone" p.5), expert (CSR budget, D&I), informational ("very well informed about Chrysalis" p.2). Tactics: coalitions (Kamla, Fiona, IT), rational persuasion (the budget to Vikram), inspirational appeal (D&I). **Ramesh** relies on an operational network (depth with Kamla and his team) and has a weak strategic one, so he learns of events from outsiders p.3–4. Power: legitimate (head of L&D, 40% of Gargi's time) and expert; losing relational and informational power. Katz: needs more human and conceptual skill. **Kamla**: legitimate and reward power (role expansion, praise), relational (CEO).

What Ramesh should do (exam-ready). (1) **Strengths first**: run the Reflected Best Self exercise to rebuild confidence and see his value (board: strengths → voice). (2) **Voice to Kamla** with competent courage: choose the time (not while she is rushing), frame it on her priorities (D&I inside the L&D strategy, team morale, no duplicated effort), bring evidence (events he learned of from outsiders, team drift), propose a role charter for Gargi's 40% and information-sharing norms; ask what she expects of him (repair P-S). (3) **Learning conversation with Gargi**: open with the third story ("we seem to have different ideas of how initiatives get planned"), separate her intent (copying him to keep him informed) from the impact (he felt blindsided), agree a weekly sync and who decides what, publicly credit her work. (4) **Re-norm the team** (P-G): agree whereabouts, consultation and autonomy rules; use Fiona as a bridge. (5) **Build a strategic network** (Vikram, Raman, division heads) and own part of the D&I story. (6) Decide on exit only after a real voice attempt. **Kamla** should communicate transparently, clarify dual reporting, avoid triangulation and visible favouritism (trust builders #3, #5).

C2 · "Go Around": AXB1344's Final Landing 2020 (A)

IIMA OB0253(A), Sharma, Gupta, Reddy & Tanwar (2026) · Session 4

Snapshot. 7 August 2020, about 19:40 IST. Air India Express (AIXL) Boeing 737-800, Dubai → Kozhikode (Calicut) repatriation flight under the Vande Bharat Mission; 184 passengers and 6 crew. Unstabilised approach in heavy rain, at night, with a tailwind onto **tabletop Runway 10**; touched down halfway down the runway, overran at about 85 knots, fell into a ~30 ft gorge and broke into three. Both pilots and 19 passengers died (21 of 190); 75 seriously injured p.1, 5, 21. **Mangalore 2010** (same airline, aircraft type and runway type): 158 of 166 killed; the FO called go-around three times and was ignored p.1, 21. **Core issues**: voice vs silence, authority gradient, psychological safety, organizational learning, accountability across levels.

Actor	Facts
PIC (captain, pilot flying)	59, ex-military, ATPL, Line Training Captain (trains and evaluates other pilots), 10,848 hours; 36 flights into Kozhikode in the past year, mostly in headwinds (complacency) p.2, 5–6.
FO (first officer, pilot monitoring)	32, CPL, about 2,000 hours; cleared only for the monitoring role; SOPs authorised *and required* him to take control p.2, 5, 8.
AIXL	Low-cost subsidiary of Air India (2004); 21 aircraft; 651 weekly departures pre-COVID; not truly independent (Air India runs the simulator under an MoU; the COO also flies for Air India) p.7, 17.
Regulator & others	DGCA (safety regulator), AAI (runs Kozhikode airport), AAIB (accident investigator) p.6–7.

What happened in the cockpit

First approach (RWY 28)	Good briefing: PIC names the weather risk, Cochin as alternate with "about half an hour hold" fuel; "Any doubts?" FO: "No" p.2, 13. Captain's wiper fails; he laughs ("What a day for the wiper to go"); missed approach p.13.
Switch to RWY 10	ATC changes runway for a departing aircraft, turning the headwind into a tailwind. PIC: "Don't do anything. Pay attention... Let's try" p.14. **No** approach briefing, landing-distance calculation, tailwind discussion or diversion discussion p.2, 14.
Final 30 seconds	Crosses the threshold at 169 knots ground speed and floats about 10 seconds p.3. FO: "Rate of descent" → PIC "Check"; "Rate of descent... Captain" (firmer) → "Yeah yeah... correcting, correcting" (discontent at being corrected); FO "(Up/Um)... OK?" (feeble, helpless); "Just check it"; "Captain?"; "Go around" (definite, at about 10 ft). No response p.3–4, 14–15.
After touchdown	Lands beyond the touchdown zone; thrust reversers deployed, stowed, redeployed (indecision) → overrun p.5.
AAIB probable cause	PF's non-adherence to SOP (continued an unstabilised approach and landed halfway down the runway despite the "Go around" call) **and** the PM's failure to take over controls and go around p.11.

Why the FO spoke but didn't act (Morrison)

Level	Inhibitors present
Individual	Age and rank gap (32 vs 59; CPL vs ATPL); the captain is a Line Training Captain who *evaluates* FOs → career risk.
Job / org perceptions	Powerlessness: one captain posted at Kozhikode against 26 FOs p.9; "FOs deferred to captains, concerns went unvoiced" p.8.
Emotions	Fear of challenging authority; futility after "Check" and "Yeah yeah... correcting"; a threat that stayed ambiguous until seconds before touchdown.
Supervisor behaviour	Authoritarian, dismissive captain ("Don't do anything. Pay attention." p.14); rushing to land so he could fly to Doha next morning p.9.
Context	"Stiff and closed work environment, where hierarchy and seniority worked to the detriment of the airline" p.19; steep authority gradient even in simulator training p.19; CRM training "not proving to be meaningful" p.8; trainers didn't intervene p.8; operations over safety p.9.
Motivators that existed	Formal voice mechanism (SOP authorises a go-around call and taking control) p.2, 5; CRM training; the FO's conscientiousness (he called out correctly and in time). They lost to the inhibitors.

Voice ≠ agency; psychological safety

The call-outs escalate in verbal risk (technical call-out → personalised challenge → hedged request → plea → command) but stop short of **taking control**, the action the SOP required. He had enough psychological safety to speak but not enough to act.

Last-line-of-defence chain: antecedents (authoritarian captains unchecked; leadership fragmented across four cities; no coaching) → belief ("stiff and closed"; challenging a captain seen as disruptive) → behaviour (no briefing for RWY 10, hedged call-outs, controls never taken) → outcome (the overrun; 21 lives). Telling FOs to "be assertive" fails while the antecedents stay the same.

Asymmetry (board): taking control helps the organization later and is ambiguous; staying deferential protects the FO now and is clear. In an ambiguous threat the culture demands that he "prove it is unsafe" (high-risk).

Silence cycle: he speaks → leader dismisses ("Check", "Yeah yeah") → "my voice doesn't matter" → feebler, more hedged calls → silence in action.

Swiss cheese: failures percolate through every layer (board)

Layer	Evidence
Individual: PIC	At least eight examiner observations (2009–14): loses concentration under stress, floats, lands beyond the touchdown zone, once needed physical assistance p.5–6, 16; failed to qualify as a B777 captain at Air India in 2013 and moved to AIXL p.5; complacency from headwind landings p.6; unprescribed anti-diabetic drugs (Glimepiride plus an Ayurvedic preparation) with hypoglycaemia risk to cognition p.6; "get-home-itis" p.9.
Individual: FO	Saw the danger and called it, but didn't take control p.5; in the simulator FOs couldn't calculate wet or contaminated landing distances p.19.
Supervisory	PIC approved as a Line Training Captain in Nov 2017 despite his record p.6; line trainers didn't correct the cockpit dynamic p.8; the 2010 recommendation that trainers observe CRM and the authority gradient from the observer's seat was never implemented p.10, 22.
Organization (AIXL)	Corporate office in Kochi, maintenance in Thiruvananthapuram, operations, training and safety chiefs' offices in Mumbai, with the operations chief based in Chennai and the training chief in Delhi → supervisory gaps p.7; safety chief with dual reporting p.7; no aviation medicine specialist since Feb 2015 p.6; one captain vs 26 FOs, PIC rostered for Doha next morning (that flight moved from 08:30 to 10:00 to fit his duty limits) p.9; SMS training cut from 5 to 3 days, flagged by DGCA in 2018 and 2019, then the manual amended to legitimise the cut p.9; flight-data monitoring at 89% (2018–19) and 94% (2020), long landings not monitored until after the crash p.9–10; simulator defects and no contaminated-runway option → "negative training" p.10.
Regulator (DGCA)	Accepted low monitoring figures and closed audits without follow-up p.9; no checks on critical airfields or high-risk flights (Jan 2019–Jun 2020), no red-eye checks, safety reviews for 2019 and 2020 unpublished, 2018 safety targets missed p.10.

Layer	Evidence
Infrastructure (AAI)	Wind sensor at 3.5 m instead of 10 m, in a valley (under-read winds); no approach radar; centreline lights not installed (chance missed in the 2017 resurfacing); no transmissometer; arresting bed in the 240 m safety area poorly maintained, with protruding concrete p.8.

Lessons not learned. Mangalore 2010 → Mangalore 2019 (VT-AYA: FO's go-around call ignored on an unstabilised approach) → Kozhikode 2020: "the same causal mechanism produced the same outcome" p.10–11. Recommendations were reported implemented through action-taken reports, but "the airline had produced documentation... It had not produced change" p.11. That is **single-loop learning**, with an **espoused theory** (safety first) vs a **theory-in-use** (operations first, dissent suppressed). Gino & Staats biases: toward *success* (closing items), *action* (operational pressure), *fitting in* (deference), *experts* (captain knows best).

Other framework hooks. Power: PIC has legitimate (command and legal responsibility), expert (hours, trainer status), coercive and reward power over FOs' careers (as an evaluator) and seniority-based referent power; the FO has only procedural authority from the SOP and the information that the approach was unsafe. **Conflict**: status (authority gradient) and process (how call-outs are handled). **Big Five (limited evidence)**: PIC: low C on SOP compliance (no briefing, ignored calls, self-medicated), low A (dismissive), stress-prone per training record; FO: high C (correct, timely calls), high A/deference, low E (hedged, "feeble"). **Fit**: PIC P-J low (repeated adverse observations); FO P-S low (captain) and P-O low (culture of silence). **Speak-up vs silence cycle**; **psych safety × accountability**: FOs sit in the Anxiety zone.

Recommendations (fix antecedents, not just the FO). Cockpit and team: captains briefed and assessed on *inviting* challenge ("if you call go-around, I will execute"); a two-challenge rule (two unanswered calls → the PM takes control); standard escalation words; simulator scenarios in which the FO must take over; mandatory briefing after any runway change. **Supervisory**: trainers observe CRM and the authority gradient from the observer seat; captains' upgrade decisions use their training records. **Organization**: an independent safety chief reporting to the CEO and board; an aviation medicine specialist; rostering buffers (no "get-home" pressure); 100% flight-data monitoring including long landings; reward speaking up and never penalise a go-around; a double-loop review of why Mangalore recommendations died on paper. **Regulator and infrastructure**: checks on critical airfields; publish safety reviews; fix the wind sensor, centreline lights and runway-end safety area.

C3 · Strike in Space HBS 9-481-008, Balbaky & McCaskey (1980) · Session 6 (power & conflict)

Snapshot. Skylab, the first US space station (1973), was built from leftover Apollo parts; programme cost $2.5 billion; three crews for 4, 8 and 12 weeks. It was "one of the most exhaustively controlled work periods in history": about six feet of teleprinter instructions a day (at least 42 instructions), every mouthful and bowel movement reported, sleep monitored with a "bunny cap" p.2. Original goal: can humans live and work in weightlessness? NASA also needed results to justify the budget and win funding for the space shuttle p.2–3. The **third crew** launched on 16 Nov 1973; on **27 Dec** (end of week 6) they stopped work for a day and turned off the radio: the first strike in space p.1, 13–14. The mission was then extended to 84 days (splashdown 8 Feb 1974) p.15.

Who	Facts
Crew 1	Conrad (cdr), Kerwin, Weitz: heroic rescue repairs; gave up days off to catch up; Conrad bypassed Mission Control for a private conference with JSC director Kraft (against policy) to drop the bicycle-ergometer experiment; reminded of the policy and the experiment was rescheduled next day p.3–4.
Crew 2	Bean (cdr), Garriott (science pilot, Stanford PhD), Lousma: close ties to crew 1; "the favorites of mission control", cheerful, did everything they were told; asked for heavy schedules and got ahead; mission "50% less productive" without Garriott's enthusiasm p.4–6. Bean advised giving crew 3 **50% more time** for first runs and locking in meals p.9–10.
Crew 3 (all rookies)	**Carr** (cdr, 41, Marine Lt Col, easy-going, regretted missing the moon), **Gibson** (science pilot, 38, PhD in engineering and solar physics, civilian, independent, dissenter, "contrariest and bitchingest", fussy aesthete), **Pogue** (pilot, Air Force, gentle, awkward and profane in weightlessness); no ties to earlier crews p.7.
Mission Control & NASA	**Neil Hutchinson**, lead flight director for all missions, proud of total control; "can't stand any form of disorganization"; would have preferred an unmanned satellite p.2, 9, 12. **Schneider** (programme director) told crew 3 to take it easy, then loaded them up p.12–13. **Kleinknecht** promised a reduced load for the first 10–12 days p.9. **Alan Shepard** (astronaut chief) reprimanded the crew p.8. **Flight surgeons** argued for the crew but had "no place to blow the whistle" p.12.

#	How the strike built up
1	**Bar raised.** Hutchinson treated crew 2's peak output as "a new standard to be expected of everyone"; scientists rushed in many late, "haphazardly worked out" experiments, so crew 3 didn't know them or why they mattered, losing the sense of meaningfulness p.6. Mission length left uncertain (56, 70 or 84 days; comet Kohoutek); launch delayed twice p.6–7.
2	**Day 1, the "barf" episode.** Entered Skylab 13 hours early; Pogue vomited. Carr: "We won't mention the barf"; Gibson agreed ("every manager in NASA would... want you to do that"). The tape recorder was on; transcripts circulated; Shepard publicly reprimanded them; Carr: "It was a dumb decision" p.7–8. From then on communications were "curt and querulous"; they made mistakes and fell behind, yet "got along very well with each other" p.8.
3	**The pace.** Mission Control ignored the lessons (Bean's 50%; the reduced load) and started them too fast p.9: 10 minutes to move between experiments; Pogue: "We are just being driven to the wall!... like a one-armed paperhanger" p.10. Stowage chaos (about 40,000 items in 100+ cabinets); Pogue's errors (iodine valve; about 80% of multispectral earth photos lost) p.10; experiments scheduled into meals, exercise cut p.10–11, evenings filled ("Off-duty activities? You gotta be kidding") p.12.
4	**No brakes.** When the crew had insomnia Hutchinson *increased* the workload, thinking them lazy; surgeons were told "the flight schedule is a nonmedical duty!" p.12. Schneider admitted "we gave them conflicting instructions"; Hutchinson: the $2.5 billion cost "caused us to change our minds" about Skylab's purpose p.13.
5	**The strike.** Carr's "declaration of independence": "we let ourself just get driven right into the ground... I'd like to know just exactly what everybody's motives are... some straight words"; healthy, alert crews make fewer mistakes and are more creative; then they turned off the radio p.13–14. **After** (slides): Mission Control: "the scheduling was too ambitious"; Carr: "the first sensitivity session in space"; Pogue: "We got along together just fine. We were bound by a common enemy: Mission Control."

Note: when engaged (science demonstrations, sun-watching) crew 3 was "often more productive and creative than their predecessors", with outstanding solar observations and earth photography p.11–12.

Sources of power (board: positional · personal · relational · informational)

Actor	Sources with evidence
Mission Control (Hutchinson)	**Legitimate**: sets every minute of the schedule; NASA policy bans private conferences p.4, 9. **Reward**: comparative feedback crews valued p.5; future flights. **Coercive**: public reprimand p.8; cuts exercise, schedules meals and evenings p.10–12. **Informational**: controls instructions, telemetry, the taped private channel p.2, 8; "we know how long it took to screw in each screw" p.9. **Expert**: planning data from two missions. **Relational**: NASA HQ, scientists (150 on one package) p.2.
Crew 3	**Expert**: only they know life in weightlessness, a truth the ground had "only vicariously" p.4; Gibson's solar physics p.7. **Informational**: they control on-board reality and can withhold it (the barf) p.7–8. **Counter-power of dependence**: Mission Control needs their labour ($4M a week) → strike and radio silence p.6, 14. **Relational**: a cohesive crew; surgeons as allies p.8, 12. **Legitimate** inside the crew (Carr). Low **referent** power with the ground (not "favorites").
Flight surgeons	Expert, but no positional power ("nonmedical duty") p.12.

Conflict: antecedents and types

Goal incompatibility	Maximise experiments to justify $2.5B and the shuttle vs crew health, pacing and the original goal of showing people can live in space p.2, 11, 13.
Differentiation	Engineers who trust machines and numbers vs astronauts living a subjective reality; veterans vs rookies; civilian scientist vs military culture p.5, 7.
Task interdependence	Ground plans, crew executes; tasks interfere with each other (Hutchinson's telescope-vs-bicycle example) p.1.
Limited resources	Crew time, $4M a week, Mission Control staff cut from 270 to 240, exercise time p.3, 6, 11.
Task conflict	What Skylab is for; experiments vs exercise and rest p.11, 13.
Process conflict	"A bare framework... a shopping list" (Gibson) vs minute-by-minute control (Hutchinson) p.1, 9.
Relationship conflict	After the reprimand: curt, querulous, ridicule, hostility p.8; "common enemy".
Status conflict	Who controls the crew's day: "we really controlled their destiny" vs the crew's "declaration of independence" p.9, 13.

Fit (asked in both 2020 and 2022 for Edward Gibson)

	Edward Gibson	Carr · Pogue	Contrast: crew 2 (Bean, Garriott)
P-J	**H** for the science: his "main purpose" was to see the sun from above the atmosphere; the solar telescope and earth observation "keep us challenged and mentally awake"; outstanding solar-observation quality p.11–12. **L** for rote checklist work ("ready for the rubber room") p.12. Overall **H/M**.	Carr **M**: rookie commander, "our lack of experience will be an embarrassment" p.7. Pogue **L–M**: slowest to adapt to weightlessness, most errors (valve, lost photos) p.7, 10.	Garriott **H**: "scientific work was play" p.6.
P-O (NASA)	**L**: NASA selected astronauts "for their extraordinary military discipline and obedience and not for their capacity for creative, independent judgment" p.5; Gibson is an independent civilian dissenter p.7 who "resented, more than anyone else, the standardized, mechanical routine" p.12.	Both **L** after the public reprimand; Carr: "we let ourself just get driven right into the ground" p.8, 13.	**H**: eager overachievers who set records, matching NASA's quantitative culture p.4–5.
P-G (crew)	**H**: the crew "got along very well with each other" p.8; aligned with Carr on the barf call p.8; experimented with Pogue on water spheres p.11; "bound by a common enemy".	Both **H** (same evidence).	**M**: occasional internal tension when overworked p.8.
P-S	**Immediate (Carr) H**: Carr's declaration voices the crew's shared view p.13. **Higher (Mission Control / Hutchinson) L**: autonomy vs total control; evenings filled: "Off-duty activities? You gotta be kidding" p.12.	With Mission Control and Shepard **L** (reprimand, more work) p.8, 12.	**H** with Mission Control ("favorites") p.4.

Big Five

	Gibson	Carr	Pogue	Hutchinson
O	**H**: imaginative planner of "perfect, trouble free, future space stations"; aesthetic sense; loved sun-watching and playful demos p.7, 11–12.	**M**: values time to "stare out the window and gather his thoughts" p.14.	**M**: enjoyed the water experiments p.11.	**L**: rigid "system"; would rather have had an unmanned satellite p.12.
C	**M**: fussy, high-quality solar work p.7, 12, but agreed to hide the vomiting and resisted the schedule p.8.	**M**: proposed hiding it, then owned it ("dumb decision") p.8; later insisted on pacing.	**L–M** under pressure: valve, flooding, filter errors p.10.	**H** (extreme): every minute programmed; can't stand disorganization p.9, 12.
E	**L–M**: prized the privacy of the docking adaptor p.9; independent; yet a vocal griper.	**M**: articulate, measured broadcasts p.13–14.	**M**.	**H**: "tough energetic" p.2.
A	**L**: "contrariest and bitchingest"; blew up at the Velcro p.7–8.	**H**: "easy-going" p.7.	**H**: "gentle" p.7.	**L**: more work despite insomnia; thought them lazy p.12.
N	**M–H**: frequent exasperation p.8.	**M**: regret and rookie apprehension p.7.	**H**: "painful, sometimes angry sense of awkwardness", "blasts of profanity", "driven to the wall" p.7, 10.	**L**: steady, confident.

Voice, silence and psychological safety. Crew 3 voiced complaints repeatedly; Mission Control didn't adjust, so **futility** grew until voice became a strike (in EVLN terms a temporary exit/neglect). The surgeons' voice was blocked ("no place to blow the whistle"; "nonmedical duty") p.12. Conrad's earlier attempt to speak up through a private conference was met with a policy reminder p.4: every response teaches. Astronauts habitually downplayed adverse effects to protect NASA funding p.7, and the public reprimand made the crew "defensive from the start" p.8: low psychological safety, then curt silence. **Influence tactics**: Mission Control used pressure (continual checking, heavier loads), legitimating (policy) and rational argument (task timings). The crew used rational persuasion (alert crews make fewer mistakes, are more creative p.13–14), personal appeals, a coalition with the surgeons, then pressure (the strike). Bean's rational advice was ignored p.9.

Team dynamics. Crew 3 vs Mission Control never left **storming**; inside the crew, strong **norming** and cohesion against an out-group ("common enemy"). **Punctuated equilibrium**: the strike came at the end of week 6 of a 12-week mission (the midpoint), followed by a reset (scheduling admitted "too ambitious") and an extension. **Process losses at NASA**: unique information ignored (Bean's and Kleinknecht's lessons p.9); anchoring on crew 2's peak p.6; conformity to "the system... doesn't want to" stop p.12; conflicting instructions p.13. **Board ratings** (groups rating each other 1–10): Mission Control rated itself 9, 9, 9 and crew 3 low (4, 3, 5); crew 3 rated Mission Control 4, 4, 4, 3, a perception gap. **Board descriptors**: Mission Control on crew 3: "slackers, rebellious, non-compliant"; crew 3 on Mission Control: "over-controlling, rigid, mismanaged"; crew 2 on crew 3: "overburdened, corporate mazdoor"; crew 1 on Mission Control: "supportive, controlling, terror".

What Mission Control should have done. Plan participatively: a framework plus a "shopping list" (Gibson) with crew input; ramp up gradually (Bean's 50% more time); protect meals, exercise and evenings; give one consistent instruction (Schneider vs Hutchinson); explain the purpose of each new experiment (meaningfulness); a private, non-punitive feedback channel and no public reprimands (psychological safety); listen to the surgeons; never benchmark one crew against another; treat the crew as experts on life in space (expert power); have the difficult conversation early ("straight words").

C4 · Paul McGinley: Leading a Multinational Team of Individuals LBS CS-16-002, Duke & Peterson · Session 7 (influence)

Snapshot. January 2013: the players' committee picks Paul McGinley from five nominees as Europe's Ryder Cup captain for Gleneagles, Scotland, September 2014, against US captain Tom Watson p.1. No prize money; prestige only p.2. **Challenges**: many nationalities, cultures and personalities vs a single-nation US team; a highly individualistic sport; the team is known only weeks ahead (9 qualify on points, 3 captain's picks a month before); three formats (foursomes: alternate shots with one ball; fourballs: own ball, best score counts; Sunday singles) needing three strategies p.1–3. **Result**: Europe won 16½ to 11½ p.15.

McGinley: Irish; Gaelic football until a broken kneecap at 19; international business degree from San Diego; professional from 1991; four European Tour wins; Ryder Cup player 2002 (holed the winning putt), 2004, 2006, all winning teams; vice-captain 2010 and 2012; Seve Trophy captain 2009 and 2011 p.3. **Never one of the star players** (ranked 6th to 12th) p.10. Björn: "He is one of us. There has never been a distance to Paul" p.1.

Team p.18: McIlroy and McDowell (N. Ireland), Stenson (Sweden), Dubuisson (France), Donaldson (Wales), Garcia (Spain), Rose, Poulter and Westwood (England), Kaymer (Germany), Bjørn (Denmark), Gallacher (Scotland). Vice-captains: Smyth, Torrance, Olazábal, Harrington, Jiménez.

What he did	Detail	Lever
Treated players as individuals	"Selfishness" is part of a golfer's DNA, "a trait to work with rather than to change"; months of one-to-one contact; no team dinners beforehand p.4.	Adaptation; P-G comfort
Made every nationality comfortable	Rolling buffet 6–10 pm with Mediterranean, British and northern European dishes, overseen by the team doctor and nutritionist p.4–5.	Inclusion; adaptation
Built identity at two levels	Represent your country, town and family as well as Europe (his Gaelic football roots); daily jersey colours with meaning (Friday: Scotland's Saltire); wall quote "The best teamwork comes from those individuals working individually towards one goal in unison"; consistent graphics and "continuity of message" p.5, 10.	Inspirational appeal; framing
Used data on "the Gleneagles examination paper"	Data team (strokeaverage.com, with him ~15 years); par fives decided the course; three of the four par fives plus the driveable par four were even-numbered → big hitter drives the even holes in foursomes (Dubuisson evens, McDowell odds); fourballs pair similar games p.6–7.	Information; technical authority; rationality
Didn't over-captain	"Show them the big facts… then stand back, hand over responsibility… Over-captaining is a mistake I was not going to make… I trust them" p.7.	Trust; empowerment
"Captain Shadow" and hidden draws	Minimal contact so players stayed in the present; quietly had the European Tour pair likely partners (and caddies) in regular events without telling them p.7–8.	Structural intervention; relational power
Knew players "through stealth"	Press-conference transcripts, managers and support teams, debriefing caddies p.8.	Informational power
Made caddies part of the team	Same accommodation, food and clothing as players; caddie-only meetings; caddies decide whether to pass information to their player → "12 guys now pulling very much in my favour" p.9.	Consultation; status "pull"; coalition
Tailored information to personality	Type A players: some want the full structure, others only their own role p.9.	Individualized influence
Borrowed Sir Alex Ferguson	Private sounding board for 14 months; delivered McGinley's chosen messages as the Tuesday guest speaker; built his confidence for managing stars p.10.	Coalition; strategic networking
Five vice-captains, "three lines of attack"	Four followed matches; the new fifth looked after the four resting players. Lines: players and caddies → vice-captains → captain plotting the next session; messages went captain → vice-captain → caddie → player p.11.	Structural intervention; delegation
Didn't overreact	Westwood and Donaldson were losing on Saturday morning; he asked the vice-captain about dynamic, energy, caddies, fatigue; told "they're just getting beaten", he kept them on and they won comfortably p.12; daily data briefings p.12–13.	Emotional stability; trust in VCs
Communicated tightly	Private end-of-day talk with each player (data + vice-captain debrief; next day's role, "nothing set in stone"); a 30-minute 9 pm team meeting on attitude; "Let me come back to you on that… I always came back to them" p.13.	Apprising; listening and following up
Handled the Garcia media storm	An ex-captain called Garcia "useless"; McGinley texted him early, talked for 45 minutes, confirmed he would play that afternoon, asked Olazábal to monitor and encourage him, and asked McIlroy (with his caddie) to play a senior role; they won, and both won their singles p.14.	Crisis "holding"; personal appeal
Refocused for singles	Saturday night switched minds back to individual play; McDowell first out; graphic "We will be the rock when the storm comes" p.14–15; the geese V-formation metaphor p.15.	Framing; inspirational appeal

Power & influence

Power	**Legitimate** (captain picks wildcards, pairings, who rests); **reward** (selection, playing time, equal treatment of caddies); **expert** (data, five Ryder Cups as player and vice-captain); **referent** ("one of us", respected); **informational** (data team, caddie and press intelligence; decides who knows what); **relational** (Ferguson, European Tour, vice-captains, caddies). **Coercive**: essentially unused.
Status	Lacked star *prestige*; earned *respect* by preparation (McDowell: "emphasis should be on leadership qualities, not on golfing credentials" p.16). Used **pull** tactics: inclusion, support, listening and following up.
Kipnis tactics	Rationality (stats behind pairings p.7); inspirational appeal (identity, colours, rock, geese); consultation (caddies, vice-captains p.9, 12); personal appeal (Garcia p.14); apprising (nightly role briefings p.13); coalitions (Ferguson, vice-captains, caddies); collaboration (resources). Not used: pressure, exchange.
Three ways to project influence	**Framing**: the real opponent is the course ("examination paper") p.6; teamwork = individuals working toward one goal p.5. **Information**: par-five league tables p.6–7. **Technical authority**: the data team; vice-captains chosen to "read golf and read games and read personalities" p.12.

Teams, culture, personality

Multicultural strategies (Brett)	**Adaptation**: accepted individualism and national identities (food, colours, "you are who you are" p.5). **Structural intervention**: data-based pairings, the fifth vice-captain, communication routed through vice-captains and caddies, controlled draws p.7–8, 11. **Managerial intervention**: captain set norms (short meetings on attitude) and acted fast in the Garcia storm p.13–14. **Exit**: not used; he kept Garcia despite public criticism.
Diversity	Surface: nine nationalities, languages, food cultures. Deep: personalities (type A; stars vs rookies), playing styles (big vs short hitters), information needs, experience. Inclusion: "proud of each other's backgrounds" p.5.
Big Five (McGinley)	C **H** ("no stone left unturned" p.16); O **H** (data team, five vice-captains, caddie role, Ferguson); A **H** ("every single person was treated the same" p.15); E **M** (low profile, "strategist behind the scenes" p.12); N **L** (doesn't overreact; "the rock").
Belbin · Chemistry	Co-ordinator + Monitor Evaluator (data) + Resource Investigator (Ferguson, data team); vice-captains as Team workers; Garcia and McIlroy as Shapers; McDowell as Implementer. Business Chemistry: Guardian (meticulous) + Integrator (inclusion).
Development	Forming accelerated by hidden draws and practice-round pairings p.8, 11; storming avoided through respect and individual comfort; performing; adjourning: "we all went back to our individual careers" p.16.
Fit & trust	P-J, P-O ("one of us"), P-G, P-S (chosen by the players' committee): all **H**. Trust: cognitive (data, planning) + affective (respect, Garcia) and he *gave* trust ("I trust them" p.7).

Use McGinley as the benchmark in compare questions. vs **Greg James**: both lead dispersed, multinational individuals, but McGinley studied each person, treated everyone equally and built structure (vice-captains, caddies), while James favoured the US sub-team and ran one meeting at one time for all. vs **Henry Tam**: clear roles and a single leader vs muddled roles and "no clear leader". vs **Hutchinson**: trust and "don't over-captain" vs "every minute programmed".

C5 · Henry Tam and the MGI Team HBS 9-404-068, Polzer, Vargas & Elfenbein (2003) · Session 10 (teams, cross-cultural)

Asked in 2020 Q2 (diversity vs Satera), 2020 Q3 (trust: Henry–Dana, Henry–Sasha), 2022 Q2 (diversity) and 2022 Q6 (Dana Soiman as networker).

Snapshot. Spring 2002, the worst job market in a decade. Henry Tam, in his final HBS semester, enters the HBS Business Plan Contest to test his abilities p.1. In late January he teams with classmate **Dana Soiman** and the three founders of **Music Games International (MGI)**, who later add two students from other schools: **seven people** p.1. Product: *Tchaikovsky's Nutcracker: The Music Game*, a CD-ROM "music puzzle" for young children; a critical success but a commercial failure, and the founders are broke p.3–5. Core dispute: Henry and Dana want an **education** foothold, the founders the larger **entertainment** (teen) market p.1, 7–8, 11–12. Mid-March: no first draft, plan due in **three weeks**, roles "muddled" p.12. Rules: at least one second-year HBS student per team p.2; judged on viability, strategy, financing and the team's ability to execute p.16.

Who	Facts (bios p.15)
Henry Tam	American, the only one until Dav joins p.10; ex-JP Morgan, IFC, PwC strategy; Columbia, Fulbright. Calm and analytical; becomes the plan's de facto leader.
Dana Soiman	Romanian; ex-CSFB, Barclays, Goldman Sachs; the only woman. Strict and structured; wants to work with kids p.5.
Sasha (founder)	From St Petersburg, "very Americanized", prefers English p.4; HBS MBA '87; IBM, Eli Lilly, Alcoa; founded Paramed and ProNetMusic. MGI's only business person: production, business manager, fundraiser p.4.
Igor (founder)	Award-winning composer and pianist from Ukraine; Sasha's friend of 20+ years p.2; "the father that holds the company together" p.4.
Roman (founder)	Composer from Ukraine; weaker English, speaks Russian with Igor p.4; e-mail only until meeting 2 p.7.
Alex	Berklee music-business student, trained as a musician in the former Soviet Union, closer in age to the students; MGI's informal adviser and the self-described bridge p.7, 10.
Dav	American MIT graduate student (software); recruited by Sasha for MGI's **MIT** contest entry; silent in meetings p.9.

When	What happened
January	Sasha e-mails HBS students for help with "children edutainment" marketing p.17; to the founders it is "like an internship" for the students (Roman) p.5. Igor's charisma wins Henry p.5. Igor has already chosen Dana (shared roots near the Romanian border), and Sasha pushes her to take Henry too: "I really wanted him" p.5–6. Henry knows Dana from a finance class; she has lined up a faculty adviser p.6. Before meeting 1 they draft 25 due-diligence questions and form **preconceptions about Sasha** from his CV p.6.
Meeting 1	Early February (Henry, Dana, Igor, Sasha). Open and eager, no roles (Dana) p.6. Sasha "very unfocused"; "we pigeonholed Sasha... as a challenge" (Henry) p.6. **Role clash**: Sasha sees business-plan writers, Igor sees help with vision and strategy; jobs later only "if things work out" p.6. Sasha's envelope of HBS alumni to call: Dana says it is premature ("a game? A service? A concept?") → heated; "complete animosity" (Igor) p.7. Tasks are later split, Henry getting the bulk (Igor); Henry senses "Dana and me versus the Russians"; Sasha sees "interns", they see leaders p.7.
Meeting 2	Roman and Alex join; "very unorganized brainstorming" (Alex); publisher vs developer, kids vs teens p.7–8. Dana wants "one more person" with seniority and market knowledge p.8. Roman: "negative chemistry"; she sees "just a salesperson", he sees her as too general p.8. Sasha calls her point "bullshit" in front of everyone and admits poor interpersonal skills p.8. Henry and Dana pre-meet, "function as a unit" and play **good cop/bad cop** on Sasha p.8–9. Nearly three hours p.9.
Meeting 3	Sasha brings Dav, unannounced, for an MIT contest entry; Henry wonders if Sasha is using them too, and "Sasha never consulted us" p.9. Their PowerPoint impresses Igor and Roman ("the coup"); Sasha's graph-paper ideas are "basically ignored" p.9, and he feels his material went unused p.10. Dav sees "HBS versus the Russians"; the founders tell Roman in the stairwell to "stick to our story" p.10.
Fridays	Eight to ten visions; every near-decision reopened p.10–11. Alex: "debate on every issue!... a clash of civilizations!" p.10; he takes Dana aside to explain the creative mentality p.11. A round-robin shows everyone still has a different vision p.11. Education vs entertainment: Sasha doubts the numbers p.11–12; Henry stays calm ("if you have other numbers, then show me") and wins respect: "leadership by example" (Alex) p.12.
Mid-March	No draft, three weeks left; Henry and Dana are the de facto "CEOs" and overloaded: "a drain", "too much to juggle" p.12–13. "There was no clear leader" (Dana) p.13. Henry: "an obligation to see this thing through" p.14.

Diversity (surface vs deep) and faultlines

Surface	**Nationality**: American (Henry, Dav), Romanian (Dana), Russian (Sasha), Ukrainian (Igor, Roman), Soviet-trained Alex p.4–5, 10. **Language**: Russian vs English p.4. **Gender**: Dana the only woman. **Age**: Sasha (MBA '87) vs students. **Organization**: HBS, MIT, Berklee, MGI.
Deep	**Function**: finance vs composition vs software. **Work style**: a "banker's meeting" vs creators who "have to waste time" p.11. **Goals**: a plan to be proud of and maybe a job p.6 vs company survival. **Strategy**: education vs entertainment p.11–12. **Roles**: leaders vs interns p.7. **Personality**: aggressive Sasha vs silent Dav p.8–9.
Faultline	Nationality, profession and goals line up: "HBS versus the Russians" p.10. Alex and Dav are "neutral outsiders" who soften it p.10.
Net effect	So far a **liability**: rich informational diversity, no process (leader, norms, decision rule, shared goal) to integrate it.

Conflict types

Task	Education vs entertainment p.11–12; publisher vs developer; kids vs teens p.7; the alumni calls p.7.
Process	Brainstorming vs structure; no decision process; "no—let's change it" p.8, 10–11; Dav added without consultation p.9.
Relationship	Sasha–Dana p.7–8; Sasha–Roman p.4, 13.
Status	Interns vs leaders p.7; the PowerPoint "coup" p.9; "no clear leader" p.13.

Brett, Behfar & Kern lens

Challenges: direct communication (Sasha: "I say what I mean without thinking about the consequences" p.8; Dana's "no"); language (Roman's English, Russian in the stairwell p.4, 10); hierarchy (founder and alumnus vs student "interns" p.7); decision norms ("everyone wants to be thorough" vs the "banker's meeting" p.10–11). **Strategies seen**: *adaptation* (Alex explains the musicians to Dana p.11; Henry's voice gets louder like theirs, which the founders respect p.12); *structural* (tasks split p.7; Dav works with Sasha and Igor separately p.9). **Missing**: *managerial intervention*; the faculty adviser p.6 is an unused senior. *Exit* is MGI's history: earlier recruits left p.4.

Trust pairs (2020 Q3)

Pair	Level and evidence (Abrams: benevolence vs competence)
Henry–Dana	**High**, both bases. Henry recruits her p.6; shared goals p.6; same banking background p.15; joint due-diligence prep p.6; pre-meetings, "functioned as a unit", coordinated good cop/bad cop p.8–9; complementary energy p.13; shared weekend workload p.13. Builders: frequent, rich communication (#3), collaborative communication (#4), discretion (#1), shared vision.
Henry–Sasha	**Low** (not hostile). Competence: CV preconceptions ("without any significant accomplishment"; "pigeonholed" p.6). Benevolence: "if things work out" p.6; "interns" p.7; Dav unannounced, "was he just using us" p.9. Sasha's side: ideas "ignored" p.9–10; good cop/bad cop is managing, not trusting p.8–9. Against: Sasha "really wanted" Henry p.5–6; Henry stays calm under Sasha's criticism p.12. Broken builders: #2, #3, #5, shared vision.
Dana–Sasha	**Very low**: "complete animosity" p.7; "negative chemistry", mutual put-downs, "bullshit" p.8.
Igor–Sasha	**High**: friends 20+ years p.2; "I trust him completely" p.4; heated talks, "no hard feelings", though not always a joint position p.13.
Roman–Sasha	**Low–M**: "problems" p.4, "personality conflicts" p.13; yet values Sasha's financial skill p.4.
Henry–Igor	**High**: drawn by Igor's charisma; Igor "liked him as a person" p.5–6; Igor's praise p.12.
Dana–Igor	**M–H**: affinity (border roots, children) p.5.

Big Five

	Henry	Dana	Sasha
O	**H**: "very analytical and very creative" p.12; learning from diversity p.14.	**M**: taken with the concept p.5; wants structure.	**M–H**: serial ventures p.15; rejects education p.12.
C	**H**: 25 questions p.6; "stacks of information" p.12.	**H**: entry and adviser ready p.6; "strict" p.8.	**M**: "unfocused" p.6, yet keeps founders "on track" p.4.
E	**M**: "calm and soft-spoken" p.12.	**H**: enthusiasm and energy p.5, 13.	**H**: "most visibly passionate" p.13.
A	**H**: "create symbiosis"; not personal p.12.	**L–M**: "just a salesperson" p.8.	**L**: "very aggressive", "bullshit" p.8.
N	**L**: "very confident and very calm" p.12.	**M–H**: "really upset" p.11.	**L–M**: "We work and we fight" p.4.

Roles, development, process losses

Belbin: Henry Co-ordinator and Monitor evaluator ("put it together into a coherent whole" p.12); Dana Completer-finisher or Implementer; Sasha Shaper ("oriented toward moving forward" p.13) and Resource investigator (alumni, investors, recruits p.4, 7, 9); Igor and Roman Plants; Alex Team worker; Dav Specialist. Many Plants, no accepted Co-ordinator → endless brainstorming. **Business Chemistry**: Dana Guardian/Driver vs the founders' Pioneers; Henry and Alex Integrators.

Development: forming restarts as members join (meetings 2 and 3); storming (Sasha–Dana); partial norming (Henry and Dana "imposed guidelines" p.13); never performing. Mid-March with three weeks left is the **transition window** (Gersick).

Process losses (one each): *conformity*, Roman told to "stick to our story" p.10; *participation*, Dav "nothing to say" p.9; *decision biases*, eight to ten visions and decisions reopened p.10–11; *conflict*, Sasha–Dana relationship conflict p.8; *influence*, slides beat graph paper regardless of content p.9. Group too big p.10–11.

Dana Soiman as a networker (2022 Q6)

1 Learning focus	**M**: sought out MGI, "really, really interested" p.5; but resists the alumni calls as "premature" p.7.
2 Common interests	**H** with Igor (border roots, children) p.5 and Henry; **L** with Sasha p.8.
3 What you can give	**H**: fills MGI's "huge hole" in finance (Sasha) p.5; contest set-up p.6.
4 Higher purpose	**M–H**: wants to work with kids p.5; short-term proof for long-term goals p.12.

Overall **moderate**: strong one-to-one ties, weak strategic networking; wants a senior person with market knowledge p.8, though she already has a faculty adviser to ask p.6. Compare Gargi (C1).

Power, influence and fit

Sasha: legitimate (founder, controls the company), relational (alumni, investors, Dav), informational; tactics: pressure, legitimating ("interns"), coalitions. **Henry and Dana**: expert and informational (research, contest know-how p.13), and dependence (MGI needs an HBS student to enter; "leverage" p.2, 7); tactics: rational persuasion ("show me" p.12), coalitions, consultation (round-robin p.11). **Igor**: referent (charisma). **Fit**: Henry P-J **H** ("biggest event in my HBS career" p.14), P-G **M** (H with Dana and Igor, L with Sasha), P-O **L–M** (MGI is wary of outsiders p.4). Dana P-J **H**, P-G **L**, P-O **L** ("friction between business and creative people" p.10). No supervisor; P-S only with Sasha as de facto boss (**L**).

What Henry should do (three weeks left). (1) Use the spring-break transition to relaunch: agree one goal, a credible plan in three weeks judged on viability p.16, and bridge the market fight: education as the short-term beachhead, entertainment as the long-term path (Dana's logic p.12; Sasha's own e-mail sought "children edutainment" help p.17). (2) Clarify roles and decision rights: Henry leads the plan (as Dav saw it p.13), Sasha leads the company and investors; founders decide vision, students decide plan structure and numbers; data settles disputes, with deadlines. (3) Smaller working sessions, an agenda and a timekeeper; brainstorming slots separate from decision slots. (4) Drop good cop/bad cop; hold separate, then joint, talks with Sasha and Dana (third story, intent vs impact); give them separate deliverables; use Alex as the bridge; credit Sasha's material. (5) Bring in the faculty adviser as the senior voice Dana wanted p.6, 8. (6) Invite every view, including Roman's dissent; delegate sections to Alex, Dav and Roman to cut Henry and Dana's overload.

C6 · Managing a Global Team: Greg James at Sun Microsystems (A) HBS 9-409-003, Neeley & DeLong · Session 11 (virtual teams)

Snapshot. Greg James, global manager in Santa Clara, leads a **45-person** customer-implementation team: **7 in France, 16 in India, 11 in the UAE, 11 in the US**, recruited 12 months earlier to serve enterprise customers in Asia and Europe p.8. In May 2008 the team failed, for the second time, to respond to a customer outage: **HS Holdings**' online-banking server was down for two hours despite a $300K 24×7 premium contract; the customer threatened to sue and wanted the money back p.1–3. VP Stephen Spurlock: "What the hell is going on?" p.3, then "Fix it. Fix it now... Something in your process is broken!" p.11. James flew to India, the UAE and France within six days p.1 and found deeper interpersonal problems. Mentor Pam Lawry (VP Global Markets): "Build consensus, everyone fully engaged, keep it simple, manage disparate voices" p.5; "your team members are all acting like they're on separate teams" p.5.

The failure chain (holes lining up)

1	The issue was logged 12 hours earlier in the **wrong queue** (account-number verification), so no page went out p.2.
2	Praveen (Mumbai) paged the on-call US manager three times but used the **weekday protocol**, forgetting it was still the weekend in California p.4.
3	He didn't call Nick's home number (everyone had it) because he'd felt **insulted**: Nick was overheard saying the Indian team wasn't competent p.4.
4	Nick's cell phone was off; Robert saw the e-mail only on Monday p.4.
5	The queue: the US asked Rahul's team to build it, but Jamal in Dubai did, from **wrong instructions** that a second programmer checked against; Mumbai owns emergency programming p.4–5.
6	The customer's phone number was dead: the contact had moved and Nick never updated it, assuming everyone would go through him p.5.
7	Elisabeth (Paris) got the customer's call an hour after the crash; Nick and Greg didn't answer; Praveen called back too late. "Santa Clara... always the hardest to reach" p.5.

Use the Swiss-cheese idea from S4: individual slips, an interpersonal rift, unclear ownership and a structure with no single owner across time zones all lined up.

Frameworks applied

Conflict types	**Task**: who owns the emergency queue and what it should do p.4–5. **Process**: escalation protocols, call time and agenda order, decisions by e-mail thread p.4, 8–10. **Relationship**: Nick's remark and Praveen's avoidance; Ahmed–Rahul; France vs US over pay and vacation p.4, 9–10. **Status**: India's "second-class" standing and maintenance work, the UAE's fear of being placed under India, US favourites, French pay p.9–10.
Virtual distance	Physical: four countries, a 13.5-hour spread. Operational: 45 people on one call, home-based work, little face time. Affinity: cultural pace, regional history (India–Pakistan), status gaps, no shared history except the US group.
Brett et al.	Direct vs indirect communication (Nick's remark; Praveen avoids rather than confronts); hierarchy (the UAE won't work under Ashok); decision norms ("two paces") p.4, 10. Strategies: adaptation (benefit differences: "part of global collaboration" p.10); structural (regional sub-teams, rotate call times, re-allocate creative work); managerial (James sets norms and protocols). Exit not needed.

Sun: $14 billion revenue, about 35,000 staff in 47 countries (2007); open-source philosophy p.6. Global teams to be close to customers, tap talent and "follow the sun"; "Rule of 11" (about 11 direct reports per manager) p.6–7. **Open Work**: work anywhere, anytime; about 60% of staff by 2008; real-estate savings of nearly half a billion dollars over 10 years; critics say face-to-face contact drives innovation p.7. Suitability survey (Exhibit 2) and training, which James's team completed p.8.

James: Stanford computer-engineering star with "an uncanny knack" for technical problems; chose Sun after extensive research ("best of both worlds"); managing a team and budget within four years; one of 50 Sun Outstanding Manager award winners p.5; "one of the best hires" p.3. Tapped by Lawry for the global role p.6.

Recruitment: France from a winding-down project; 16 IIT graduates hired in a week in Mumbai from 75 résumés; UAE the same way; the US team inherited from an acquired start-up with a history of working together p.8.

Every sub-team has a grievance

India (Rahul Ashok)	"Second-class citizens": fewer agenda items, reviewed last, interrupted; they start at 06:30 and the call runs 20:30–22:00 IST; they get maintenance and firefighting, not the creative customization work: "If we are that good, how come we are not good enough to get the creative work?" p.9. Ashok: eight years at Sun (seven in Santa Clara), on track to run Asia-Pacific including the UAE, a role model p.9.
France (Jacqueline Martin, Elisabeth Fournier)	A US salary leaked: the French earn 30% less ("compensation mismatch"); James said pay follows local markets p.9. Martin: 50-hour weeks, "We work from home, but we are never home", missed her daughter's recital p.9. Americans resent the French legal vacations; James quietly gave the French more work p.10.
UAE (Ahmed Nazr)	Little face time with James; fear of becoming a sub-group under India; fear that their evaluations will suffer because James doesn't understand their market; relationship-building culture means missed deadlines, "two paces" p.10. Strained relations with Ashok's team; Devilal suspects it's because Ahmed is from Pakistan p.10.
US (Nick Elliott, Robert Chan)	Seen as "favorites": water-cooler access; others get e-mail threads after decisions are made; "With Greg, the rich get richer and the poor get poorer" p.10. They justify their pay by French job security p.9.

The weekly call: all 45 at 08:00 Pacific = 20:30 India, 19:00 UAE, 17:00 France; a topics list the night before, commitments pushed for every item, starts and ends on time p.8.

Mortensen & Haas	Hybridity positioning: the US group has resource access (informal information) and visibility to the boss, so "the rich get richer". Fix: track and communicate, redistribute access and visibility, educate on bias, watch key moments (the UAE's evaluation fear).
Dinh et al.	Cognitive trust: unclear roles (who owns the queue), no shared norms for escalation. Affective trust: no inclusive community ("second-class"), nothing outside work; backup behaviour failed (nobody called Nick's home).
Voice	India's and the UAE's grievances surfaced only on the crisis visit p.9–10: futility (last on the agenda, interrupted), fear (evaluations), no formal channel.

Ferrazzi gap analysis

Right team	45 on one call vs under 10 (and Sun's own Rule of 11); hired for talent, not for communication skill or cultural sensitivity (Nick).
Right leadership	Predictable but one-way calls; no candour channel; unclear rules on escalation, ownership and response time.
Right touchpoints	No face-to-face kickoff (hired site by site); visits only in a crisis; only the US gets water-cooler time.
Right technology	Rated well (Exhibit 4), but the escalation design failed: the queue wasn't linked to the main support queue and sent no automatic page p.5.

Exhibit 4 (Open Work satisfaction, approx. Americas / Asia-Pacific / Europe & ME) p.15: work-task effectiveness 97 / 85 / 92; technology 94 / 84 / 89; **distance collaboration lowest everywhere: 70 / 52 / 60**; HR practices 86 / 66 / 70; management support 86 / 73 / **67**; employee satisfaction 90 / 73 / 74; assimilation of new assignees 74 / **80** / 69. The Americas lead on nearly everything; the gap is collaboration and management support, not technology.

Greg James: Big Five, Katz, fit

Big Five: C **H** (research before choosing Sun; predictable agenda; on-time calls; "meticulous career planning" p.5, 8, 11); O **M–H** (embraced Open Work and a global role p.3, 8); E **M** (water-cooler talk with the US group; reaches out to Lawry p.3, 10); A **H** (wants fairness, stung by the "rich get richer" remark p.10); N **M–H** under stress (three hours' sleep, can't move, heart racing p.1, 11). **Katz**: technical **H**; human **L** (missed every sub-team's feelings); conceptual **M** (only now questions the structure p.11). **Fit**: P-J **M** (outstanding technical manager, new to multicultural leadership: "no idea how to recruit new hires in other countries" p.8); P-O **H** p.5; P-G **H** with the US group, **L** with India, the UAE and France p.9–10; P-S **H** with Lawry, **L** with Spurlock now p.3, 11. **Power**: legitimate, reward (work allocation, evaluations), expert; little referent power outside the US group; informational asymmetry (US-first threads).

Action plan. Now (Spurlock's process fix): one escalation protocol for every day of the week with an automatic page to on-call managers; every queue feeds the main support queue; one named owner per critical account in each time zone, with a hand-off checklist; a contact database updated monthly; a blameless post-mortem shared with all four sites; a recovery plan for HS Holdings. **Next 90 days (team)**: replace the 45-person call with a site-leads call (Rule of 11) plus regional calls; rotate call times and agenda order; publish decisions to all sites at once; give India a share of customization work and rotate firefighting; confirm the UAE reports to James, not Ashok, and set deadlines that allow for relationship-building; explain pay policy openly (local markets, total rewards) and rebalance workload openly, not quietly; a difficult conversation with Nick about his remark; a face-to-face offsite; rotating site visits; virtual coffee and cross-site recognition. **Longer term**: a team charter, a candour channel, cultural-intelligence training, a quarterly per-site inclusion survey (like Exhibit 4), and managers evaluated on cross-site collaboration. Lawry's lens: consensus, engagement, simplicity, disparate voices p.5.

C7 · Asian Toys (a role play) IIMA IMG0015EX, J. P. Singh (1998) · Session 15 (teams in crisis)

Snapshot. Friday 13 September: Asian Toys learns that a **second child** has died of suffocation after inhaling a part of its **Play Time** construction toy; an autopsy confirms it four days later. Chairman **Chamanlal**, grandson of the founder, must decide a course of action with his key executives p.1. **Company**: founded 1911 by Shiv Lal (wooden toys); plastics and own manufacturing from 1978 p.1. **Play Time**: "the toy that makes toys": flexible plastic shapes, **reusable rubber rivets** and a hand tool. About 10,000 sets sold in year one at Rs 150–175; over 20,000 last year; **firm bookings of 35,000 sets** for the Dussehra, Diwali and Christmas season, ready for dispatch p.1. **Rules**: voluntary industry (TMAI) safety standards published by the Indian Standards Bureau; age labelling where safety depends on the child's age p.1. The Consumer Safety Commission (CSC) can remove hazardous toys, and manufacturers, distributors and retailers **must report any evidence of a defect or hazard** to the Bureau under the Consumer Safety Act p.2.

When	Event
Development	Two years of safety scrutiny; "a thoroughly safe toy" (Chamanlal) p.2.
19 January	An eight-year-old in Ahmedabad, playing ball with a rivet in his mouth, chokes and dies; the autopsy finds the rivet in his right lung p.2.
4 April	The industry association's counsel tells Mr Lal. The family's lawyer had gone to the CSC; its regional office evaluated the hazard and recommended no action; the company called it "an isolated freak accident" p.2.
13 September	A **Bombay newspaper reporter** phones: a nine-year-old in Juhu has suffocated on a Play Time rivet; confirmed on Monday p.2.
Lal's facts	Both deaths came from misuse; the toy meets every voluntary and industry standard; no agency is pressing; no serious accident in 80 years despite lakhs of small parts; but two deaths seven months apart, **same part, same product** p.2–3.
The meeting	GMs of Manufacturing, Marketing and Finance, the PR Manager and the Legal Adviser p.3.

Why it is a crisis (S15 elements)

Ambiguity	Cause (misuse, or a foreseeable hazard because children put small parts in their mouths?), effect (brand, liability) and means (four options).
High stakes	Children's lives; an 80-year name; 35,000 booked sets (about Rs 52–61 lakh at retail); some 30,000 sets already in homes (10,000 + 20,000+).
Urgency	A reporter already has the story; the festive stock is ready to ship.
Rarity	The first fatality in 80 years.
Stakeholders	Parents and children, retailers, regulators (CSC, Bureau), the industry body, employees, the media.

Bundy et al.: where it went wrong and what fits now

Pre-crisis: the April death was a warning signal read as a "freak accident"; compliance with *voluntary* standards replaced risk thinking (single-loop learning, as in AXB1344). **During**: leadership plus managing stakeholder perceptions; "holding" for staff and families. **Post-crisis**: the response must match how stakeholders **attribute responsibility**. With the same part failing twice in a children's toy, and an earlier warning, the public will blame the company, so an **accommodative** response (empathy, recall, corrective action) fits and a "misuse" defence (denial or excuse) will backfire.

Options matrix (the four Mr Lal listed p.3)

Option	For	Against
1 Do nothing	No cost; compliant with voluntary standards; no regulator pressure; misuse.	Same part, two deaths; the press knows; legal duty to report evidence of a hazard; a third death would be catastrophic; contradicts "we pride ourselves on safety".
2 Statement + label	Fast, cheap, candid; fits the age-labelling standard.	Doesn't reach sets already in homes; children ignore labels; blames parents; looks minimal.
3 Modify	Removes the hazard from now on (a rivet too big to inhale, or fixed); saves the line.	Takes time in peak season; doesn't fix sets in the field; signals a design defect.
4 Total recall	Strongest protection and moral position; rebuilds trust; gets ahead of the regulator.	Highest cost (35,000 booked sets plus field recall and logistics); lost season; may be read as admitting liability.

Defensible recommendation. Stop dispatch today; voluntary recall or a free replacement-rivet kit for sets in homes; report to the Bureau and the CSC; a public statement with empathy and a parents' hotline; redesign the rivet (too large to inhale) with age warnings; relaunch after independent testing. Decide the criteria first: **child safety, then trust, then cost**.

The executive meeting as a team (S12–13, S15, S5)

Typical positions in the role play (argue interests, not positions): Manufacturing: pride in testing, time and cost to retool. Marketing: the festive season, dealers, the brand. Finance: recall cost vs lawsuits and lost future sales. PR: the reporter, key messages. Legal: liability and the misuse defence vs the duty to report. Chairman: three generations of reputation; the final call.

Process risks: a single-leader working group (Katzenbach) that defers to the Chairman (conformity, Abilene paradox); functional silos and positional bargaining; anchoring on "misuse" and "meets standards"; information held by one function not shared (common-knowledge effect); influence by rank. A crisis is exactly when a **real top team** makes sense: urgency, integrated skills, a collective work-product.

Better process (Hill's four steps): define the problem (misuse, or a foreseeable hazard?); agree criteria before options; generate combinations; critique with a devil's advocate; assign owners and deadlines (recall, redesign, regulator, media).

Media and "holding"

Key messages: deep sympathy to both families; what we know; the steps already taken (dispatch stopped, recall or replacement, working with the CSC and the Bureau); a hotline for parents; a commitment to share more as facts emerge. **Avoid**: "no comment", speculation, blaming "misuse", jargon, "off the record" (Weiner). **Holding**: acknowledge the grief and anxiety inside the company, give context, and turn the urge to act into purposeful tasks.

"Your learnings in PLP format" (2012 Q3)

What happened	My role, the options, what we decided and how.
What I noticed or felt	e.g. I argued my function's interest; the reporter's call created pressure; we anchored on "misuse".
Concept	Crisis elements; Bundy's attribution match; groupthink; interests vs positions; Katzenbach's top team.
About me	Under urgency: speed vs reflection; deference vs voice.
Next time	Set criteria first; ask "what if it were our child?"; separate the legal question from the moral one; name a devil's advocate.

C8 · The Satera Team at Imatron Systems (A): the 2020 exam case, worked HBS 9-803-141, Amabile & Schatzel (2003)

Not in the 2026 folder; it is here as a full worked example of how to answer an unseen-case paper. Four of the six 2020 questions used it.

Snapshot. Early September 1999. Rick Levinger, VP R&D of the Remote Imaging Division (RID) at Imatron Systems (ISI), calls in team leader **Gary Pinto**. Satera ("satellite camera") is a tiny, light imaging system to document pollution and coastal erosion from space: a platform technology and a profit driver for 2000–01. The prototype is due to the US government on **1 April 2000**, with a penalty clause. Progress has stalled on the **support structure**, which must be strong, light and survive launch vibration, and which gates the whole mechanical design p.1. Cause: senior mechanical engineers **Ira Lovas** and **David Bennett**, whose debate has turned into "nasty, unproductive bickering" p.1. Pinto has already chosen a design (Lovas's) but doesn't know how to announce it or get the two to collaborate p.3, 8. **ISI**: founded 1983, Silver Spring, Maryland; private; about $300M revenue; 405 staff, all on one site; the US government is its biggest customer; RID is newest and most profitable, working with the EPA p.3.

Member (Exhibit 1, p.10)	Age	Role · education · tenure
Gary Pinto	45	Team leader; master's (mechanical and electrical); patent; 15 yrs
Ira Lovas	44	Senior mech. engineer, co-leads mechanical design; master's; patent; 12 yrs
David Bennett	39	Senior mech. engineer, co-leads mechanical design; master's; patent; 9 yrs
Steve Rowling	34	Senior electrical engineer, leads electrical design; master's; patent; 10 yrs
Jean Mahoney	48	Electrical engineer; bachelor's, studying for a master's; 6 yrs
Katherine Baxter	35	Mechanical engineer; bachelor's, studying for a master's; 3 yrs
Derek Delaney	28	Assistant mechanical engineer; bachelor's; 1 yr

Key evidence

- **Styles**: Lovas methodical, detail-oriented, tried-and-true; Bennett big-picture, many angles, never-tried solutions; "speaking different languages"; eye-rolling p.2.
- Pinto let them build **separate prototypes** for two weeks; removing either is "not a feasible option" (expertise, customer relationships) p.2.
- Baxter's confidential evaluation: unpleasant to work with the pair; the team freezes at major decisions because nobody wants to choose one engineer's idea over the other's; that "nobody" is Pinto; the team is "holding its breath" p.2.
- Others saw which design was better "but were too intimidated to speak up" p.3.
- Highly educated, four patents, intrinsically motivated, up to 19-hour days; "selected because they like to work" p.3.
- Rowling: "'team' is perhaps the wrong word"; diverse in age, perspectives and tasks, but no trust to use that diversity; early team-building ignored p.4. Little formal or informal communication; electrical and mechanical engineers barely know each other's work; Pinto must reach each member personally; stilted meetings p.4. Mahoney: "never seemed to gel" p.4.
- **Exhibits** (approx.): conflict 4.4 vs 2.8–3.5 for teams A–C, and progress 3.9 vs about 4.5, so Satera is the only team with more conflict than progress p.11; work-group support 4.05 vs 4.8–5.15 p.12; Satera alone rates its **own** creativity and quality above the team's (creativity 4.25 vs 3.6; quality 4.45 vs 3.95) p.13.
- **Lovas**: quiet, speaks only when addressed; solid judgment; resents Bennett's second-guessing ("physically painful for David to let me make a decision") p.4; valued Pinto's backing of his equal status; "hand him any technology, and he will make it better" p.5.
- **Bennett**: "If only I was the sole leader..."; "I'm really not confident that Ira knows what he is doing"; "No meeting goes silent for very long if David is in the room!"; "not very cooperative and is insistent on doing things his way" p.5.
- **Pinto**: doubts his ability with a "volatile" team, though management rates him effective; praise plus constructive criticism; believes in hierarchy but welcomes and uses input; read team bios early p.5; very knowledgeable; invites concerns; resolved a past conflict (Parker and Collins) by separate then joint talks, but those methods have failed here p.6.
- **The test** (whole team present, though some wanted it private p.6): Bennett's light "bicycle wheel" warps within 20 seconds; he isn't worried p.6–7. Lovas speaks first, boldly: no time, no budget, no precedent, "too risky"; Bennett's rebuttal rises in volume; **nobody steps in** p.7. Lovas's aluminium honeycomb holds for three minutes; Baxter: "pretty solid"; "Could we make it lighter?" "Maybe... I will need some time" p.8. Pinto's "OK!... think it over" leaves people unsure what to think about p.8.
- **Break room**: "close-minded" vs "undisciplined... reinvent the wheel... The government is paying us to deliver something that works"; Bennett: "Why won't anyone let me make a difference?"; Pinto hears sadness; Lovas: "Gary is a smart guy, and fair" p.9.

Model answers to the 2020 questions

Q1a Conflict types	**Task**: wheel vs honeycomb, innovation vs reliability p.2, 7. **Relationship**: eye-rolling, "nasty bickering", "not confident Ira knows", "close-minded" vs "undisciplined" p.1–2, 5, 9. Also **status** (Bennett wants to be sole leader; Lovas values equal status p.4–5) and **process** (tried-and-true vs never-tried methods; team vs private review p.2, 6).
Q1b Two fixes each	**Task**: (1) agree the criteria (weight, endurance, cost, schedule) and announce the choice with the test data, so the decision is about evidence, not people; (2) set a joint goal: make the honeycomb lighter using Bennett's lightness ideas, with Bennett leading that workstream (and his wheel parked for the next-generation platform). **Relationship**: (1) separate conversations, then a joint one using the third story (two cognitive styles, Guardian vs Pioneer) and intent vs impact; (2) ground rules (no eye-rolling; ideas as suggestions), shared credit (joint patent), and real team-building time.
Q2 Diversity vs Henry Tam	**Similar**: deep-level diversity in cognitive and work style drives the conflict (Lovas vs Bennett; structured HBS pair vs relaxed founders); functional diversity poorly integrated (mechanical vs electrical engineers vs business, music, software); one dyad's conflict paralyses the team while others stay out. **Different**: surface-level, Satera is one nationality, one site, one company vs MGI's American, Romanian, Russian and Ukrainian members from four institutions; Satera has a formal leader and tenure hierarchy vs no leader at MGI; Satera shares one goal (the 1 April prototype) vs MGI's split goals; Satera's membership is stable and full-time vs MGI's fluid, part-time one.
Q4 Voice upward	**Motivators**: Pinto's consultative style (welcomes input, implements ideas, invites concerns: Bennett's purchasing worry p.5–6); confidential team evaluations (Baxter p.2); Bennett's extraversion p.5; intrinsic motivation p.3. **Inhibitors**: fear of being pulled into the feud and of choosing sides ("too intimidated" p.3; nobody steps in p.7); futility (Bennett: "Why won't anyone let me make a difference?" p.9); Lovas's reserved disposition p.4; low trust and communication p.4; vague requests from the leader ("think it over" p.8).

Q5 Big Five	**Lovas**: O **M** (tried-and-true, yet a nature-inspired honeycomb p.5, 8); C **H** (methodical, timely, checked outsourcing p.2, 5, 8); E **L** (speaks only when addressed p.4); A **M** (professional, calls Pinto fair, but resentful and cutting p.4, 9); N **L–M** ("cool, calm, and collected" p.8, though he needs Pinto's backing). **Bennett**: O **H** (never-tried ideas, the skyscraper analogy p.2, 7); C **L–M** (less methodical; shrugs off the failure p.5, 7); E **H** (volunteers first; never silent p.5–6); A **L** (uncooperative, insists on his way p.5); N **M–H** (frustration "triggered", sadness, loses "a piece of himself" p.7, 9).

Q6a Fit	**Lovas**: P-G **M** (respected, Baxter backs his design, but locked in conflict p.2, 8); P-O **H** (12 years; a low-risk government contractor that wants "something that works" p.4, 9). **Bennett**: P-G **L** (dreaded as a pair; ideas met with "silence and looks of confusion" p.2, 5); P-O **L–M** (patent and nine years, but doubts ISI will "ever be brave enough to trust his ingenuity" p.8). Both: P-J **H**; P-S **H** (both respect Pinto p.6, 9).

Other lenses: Belbin: Lovas Monitor evaluator/Implementer, Bennett Plant/Shaper, Pinto Co-ordinator. Business Chemistry: Lovas Guardian vs Bennett Pioneer (opposites: "pull your opposites closer"), Pinto Integrator. Process losses: participation (others silent), conformity (nobody wants to choose), decision paralysis, relationship conflict instead of creative abrasion. Pinto: C **H**, A **H**, O **M–H**, N **M** (self-doubt p.5, 9).

D · Cross-Case Comparison Tables

For "compare and contrast" questions. Each cell compresses the case bank in Part C; go there for page numbers. The marking scheme pays for the **type** (of diversity, fit, conflict, power) plus **evidence from each case**.

D1 · Diversity across teams

Team	Surface-level	Deep-level	Integration (inclusion, leader, structure)	Outcome
MGI (C5)	American, Romanian, Russian and Ukrainian members; Russian vs English; one woman; an older alumnus vs students; four institutions.	Finance vs music vs software; "banker's meeting" vs open brainstorming; a plan and a job vs company survival; education vs entertainment; leaders vs "interns".	**None**: no leader, norms or decision rule; "HBS versus the Russians" faultline.	No draft with three weeks left.
Sun (C6)	Four countries and time zones; different pay levels and labour laws; Pakistan/India history.	Relationship-building pace vs deadline pace; status perceptions; only the US group shares a history.	**Weak**: one US-timed call, US-first e-mail; sub-teams = sites (geographic faultline).	Two missed outages; lawsuit threat.
Europe Ryder Cup (C4)	Nine nationalities, languages, food cultures.	Personalities, playing styles (long vs short hitters), information needs, stars vs rookies.	**Strong**: food, colours, dual identity, data-based pairings, vice-captains and caddies.	Won 16½–11½.
Satera (C8)	Low: one site, one company, one nationality; ages 28–48, tenure 1–15 years.	Cognitive style (methodical vs unorthodox); function (mechanical vs electrical).	**Weak**: little communication, no trust to use the diversity (Rowling).	Design stalled; deadline at risk.
Skylab (C3)	Civilian scientist vs military pilots; rookies vs veterans; ground vs space.	Autonomy and science vs control and output; lived experience of weightlessness.	**High** inside the crew ("common enemy"); **low** with Mission Control.	Strike; then a reset.
L&D team (C1)	Age and experience (15+ years at an oil major vs a young recruit from Microsoft and TISS).	Process and consensus vs speed and autonomy; L&D vs D&I/CSR priorities.	**Weak**: no role charter, dual reporting, boss triangulates.	Ramesh drifts toward exit.
AXB1344 (C2)	Age 59 vs 32.	Rank and licence (ATPL, line training captain vs CPL); norms of deference.	**Steep authority gradient**; CRM not internalized.	Silence in action; crash.

Answer template (2 similarities + 2 differences, 1.5 marks each): "**Similarity 1 (deep-level, cognitive style)**: in Satera, Lovas's tried-and-true method vs Bennett's never-tried ideas; in MGI, the HBS pair's structured meetings vs the founders' open brainstorming. In both, the style gap turned into relationship conflict." Name the **type**, then give **one piece of evidence per case**. Good contrasts: surface-level (one nation vs many), presence of a leader, shared vs split goals, stable vs fluid membership, and whether anyone integrated the differences (McGinley did; Greg James didn't).

D2 · Fit across individuals

Person	P-J	P-O	P-G	P-S
Ramesh	**H→M**	**M↓**	**L**	**L** (Kamla)
Gargi	**H**	**H**	**M–L**	**H** Kamla · **L** Ramesh
Gibson	**H** science · **L** rote	**L**	**H**	**H** Carr · **L** MC
Carr	**M**	**L**	**H**	**L** MC
Greg James	**M**	**H**	**H** US · **L** others	**H** Lawry · **L** Spurlock
Henry Tam	**H**	**L–M**	**M**	**L** (Sasha)
Dana Soiman	**H**	**L**	**L**	–
Lovas	**H**	**H**	**M**	**H**
Bennett	**H**	**L–M**	**L**	**H**
McGinley	**H**	**H**	**H**	**H** (players' committee)
AXB FO	**M**	**L**	–	**L** (PIC)
AXB PIC	**L**	**M**	–	–

Remember (Kristof-Brown et al.): P-J predicts satisfaction (.56) and performance (.20) best; P-O predicts satisfaction and intent to quit; P-G and P-S can't be judged before entry. Low fit on several dimensions → EVLN exit or neglect (Ramesh, crew 3, Bennett).

D3 · Trust pairs

Pair	Level	Core evidence · builder present or broken
Ramesh–Kamla	**Eroding**	Hired into his team without telling him; "sort it out with Gargi"; no calls on vacation · #3 communication, #5 fairness broken.
Ramesh–Gargi	**Comp. M · Benev. L**	"Very talented... high performer" vs copies but never consults.
Gargi–Kamla	**H**	Mentor and favourite.
Henry–Dana	**H**	Shared goals and background; pre-meetings, "functioned as a unit"; shared work · #3, #4, shared vision.
Henry–Sasha	**L**	CV preconceptions; "if things work out"; "interns"; Dav unannounced; Sasha ignored · #2, #3, #5 broken.
Dana–Sasha	**Very L**	"Complete animosity"; "negative chemistry"; public put-downs.
Crew 3–Mission Control	**L**	Public reprimand; workload raised during insomnia; conflicting instructions.
McGinley–players	**H**	"One of us"; "I trust them"; always came back with answers.
Greg–non-US teams	**L**	US-first threads; "rich get richer"; evaluation fears.
Praveen–Nick	**L**	"Not competent" remark → no call to his home.
Lovas–Bennett	**L** benev. · **M** comp.	Each calls the other able but "close-minded" / "undisciplined".
FO–PIC (AXB)	**L** (deference)	Calls dismissed ("Check", "Yeah yeah... correcting").

D4 · Voice & silence

Case	Who stays quiet, and why (inhibitors)	What helped or would help
AXB1344	FO speaks but never takes control: rank and age gap, the captain evaluates FOs, dismissal → futility, a "stiff and closed" culture.	SOP and CRM existed but lost; two-challenge rule, captains rated on inviting challenge.
Skylab	Crew complaints ignored → futility → strike; surgeons blocked ("nonmedical duty"); public reprimand → defensive silence.	A private, non-punitive channel; listen to experts; one consistent instruction.
Satera	Members "too intimidated" to take sides; Bennett's futility; Lovas reserved; vague "think it over".	Pinto's open door and confidential evaluations; round-robin input.
Sun	India and the UAE silent until the crisis visit (last on agenda, interrupted, evaluation fears); Praveen avoids Nick.	Rotate agenda and time; site-lead voice; repair the Nick rift.
Chrysalis	Ramesh's tentative voice to a rushing boss → loyalty, neglect, then exit.	Strengths (RBS) → competent courage: timing, framing, evidence.
MGI	Dav "nothing to say"; Roman told to "stick to our story"; Sasha's ideas ignored; Dana's "no" resented.	A process leader, round-robins and gatekeeping.
Ryder Cup	Little silence: voice routed through vice-captains and caddies; private end-of-day talks; "I always came back to them".	The benchmark: every response teaches people whether voice is worth it.

D5 · Power & influence (summary; full power maps in S6)

Actor	Main power bases	Tactics and effect
Kamla	Legitimate, reward, relational (CEO)	Triangulation; favouritism erodes trust.
Gargi	Referent, expert, relational, informational	Coalitions, rational persuasion, inspirational appeal → wins.
Ramesh	Legitimate, expert (fading relational and informational)	Little influence; avoids conflict.
AXB PIC	Legitimate, expert, coercive and reward over FOs' careers	Dismissal silences the FO.
Mission Control	Legitimate, coercive, informational, reward	Pressure and legitimating → strike.
Crew 3	Expert, informational, dependence (counter-power)	Rational persuasion → coalition (surgeons) → strike.
McGinley	Referent, expert, informational, relational, legitimate	Rationality, inspirational appeal, consultation, apprising, coalitions; "pull" status → wins.
Sasha	Legitimate (founder), informational, relational	Pressure, legitimating, coalition (Dav) → distrust.
Henry and Dana	Expert, informational, dependence (MGI needs an HBS student)	Rational persuasion ("show me"), coalitions, good cop/bad cop.
Greg James	Legitimate, reward, expert; low referent abroad	Predictable calls; "explaining" pay → resentment.
Gary Pinto	Legitimate, expert (respected by both)	Consultation; avoids announcing the decision.

D6 · Conflict & process losses

Case	Task	Relationship	Process	Status	Process losses (Hill / S12–13)
Chrysalis	What counts as L&D work	Ramesh's resentment of Gargi	Consult first vs run with it	Credit for D&I; possible role expansion	Participation (Ramesh bypassed); influence by favour, not role.
Skylab	Purpose: science vs output to justify cost	Curt, querulous, "common enemy"	Shopping list vs minute-by-minute plan	Who controls the crew's day	Unique information ignored (Bean's 50%); anchoring on crew 2; conflicting instructions.
MGI	Education vs entertainment	Sasha–Dana; Roman–Sasha	Brainstorm vs structure; no decision rule	Interns vs partners; who leads	Conformity ("stick to our story"); participation (Dav silent); decisions reopened; influence by format (slides vs graph paper).
Sun	Queue ownership and spec	Nick's remark; Ahmed–Rahul; France–US	Escalation protocols; call time and agenda	India "second-class"; UAE under India?; US favourites	Participation (India last, interrupted); influence by proximity; social loafing on a 45-person call.
Satera	Wheel vs honeycomb	Eye-rolling; "close-minded" vs "undisciplined"	Tried-and-true vs never-tried methods	Bennett wants to be sole leader	Conformity (nobody chooses); participation (others silent); relationship conflict instead of creative abrasion.
Asian Toys	Which of four options	(risk) functions blaming each other	How to decide: Chairman vs team	Functions protecting turf	Groupthink and deference; anchoring on "misuse"; common-knowledge effect.
AXB1344	Land or go around	–	How call-outs are handled	Authority gradient	Conformity; influence by rank, not information.

D7 · Leaders compared

Leader	Style	What worked	What failed	Lesson (framework)
Paul McGinley	Quiet strategist; data plus empathy; "don't over-captain"	Individual care, dual identity, structure (vice-captains, caddies), closed feedback loops	–	Influence without star prestige: pull tactics, framing, information, technical authority; Brett's adaptation plus structure.
Greg James	Technical star; predictable, US-centred	Fast recruitment; disciplined calls	Proximity bias; one-size call; ignored status and culture	Ferrazzi's four must-haves; Mortensen & Haas fairness; Katz human skill.
Neil Hutchinson	Total control, numbers-driven	Planning precision	Ignored lessons and experts; benchmarked crews; punished voice	Power without legitimacy breeds resistance; listen to the people doing the work.
Gary Pinto	Consultative, fair, knowledgeable	Trusted by both engineers; open door	Avoids the hard call; lets the team "hold its breath"	Decide, explain with data, then structure collaboration; difficult conversations.
Kamla	Results-driven, reserved	Spotted and backed talent	Triangulation, favouritism, no role clarity	Trust builders #3 and #5; P-S fit.
AXB PIC	Authoritarian, dismissive	Good first briefing	Silenced challenge; ignored SOP	Psychological safety; voice ≠ agency.
Henry Tam	Calm, analytical facilitator with no formal role	Data over opinion ("show me"); calm under fire; adapts to the group's style; "leadership by example"	Preconceptions about Sasha; good cop/bad cop; no early roles or decision rule	Self-managed teams without a known leader do worse (Hill); reset at the midpoint.
Chamanlal	Family custodian; decides with executives	Calls the functional heads together	Treated the first death as a "freak accident"	Bundy: prevention and learning; Katzenbach: a crisis needs a real top team.

E · Past Papers & Likely Questions

Every paper so far: 3 hours, 35 marks, about six questions, open book. 2020 was typed with word limits (300 words for 5 marks, 250 for 4, 350 for 6); 2022 was handwritten in the space provided. Cases marked † are not in your 2026 folder, so only the approach is given.

E1 · 2020 paper (with the Satera case attached)

Q	Question (marks)	Model outline · where to look
1a	Two significant conflict types in Satera, with evidence (5)	Task (wheel vs honeycomb) + relationship (eye-rolling; "close-minded" vs "undisciplined"); status or process as alternates. Definitions from S11. → **C8 Q1a**.
1b	What Gary Pinto should do: two implementable suggestions per conflict type (5)	Task: criteria first and announce with data; a joint "make it lighter" goal with Bennett leading the weight work. Relationship: separate then joint talks (third story, intent vs impact; Brett & Goldberg), ground rules and shared credit. → **C8 Q1b**, S8.
2	As Gary Pinto, compare your team's diversity with Henry Tam's MGI team (5)	Two similarities (deep-level cognitive and work styles; functional diversity poorly integrated; one dyad's conflict paralyses) + two differences (surface: one nation vs many; formal leader vs none; one goal vs split goals; stable vs fluid membership). → **C8 Q2**, **D1**.
3	Trust between (a) Henry and Dana, (b) Henry and Sasha (5)	(a) High: shared goals and banking background, joint preparation, pre-meetings, "functioned as a unit", shared workload (p.6, 8–9, 13). (b) Low: CV preconceptions (p.6), "if things work out" (p.6), "interns" (p.7), Dav unannounced and "was he just using us" (p.9), Sasha's ideas ignored (p.9–10); note that Sasha "really wanted" Henry (p.5–6). Use benevolence vs competence (Abrams). → **C5**, S2.
4	Two factors each that motivate or inhibit voicing concerns upward in Linda Groen's team (Ghomeshi at CBC†) and Gary Pinto's team (4)	Morrison's table (individual, job and organization perceptions, emotions, supervisor, context). Satera: motivators = Pinto's consultative style, confidential evaluations; inhibitors = fear of taking sides, futility. For Ghomeshi†: look for a star's power, fear of career risk, futility after earlier complaints, and whether formal channels existed. → **C8 Q4**, S4.
5	Big Five of Ira Lovas and David Bennett (5)	All five traits for each, level + evidence (0.5 + 0.5). → **C8 Q5**.
6	Fit: (a) Lovas and Bennett with team and organization (2); (b) all four for Jian Ghomeshi† (2); (c) all four for Edward Gibson (2)	(a) → **C8 Q6a**. (b)† State each fit's level with one fact: P-J (performance as host), P-O (CBC's values vs his conduct), P-G (colleagues), P-S (who protected or confronted him). (c) → **C3** fit table: P-J H (science), P-O L, P-G H, P-S H with Carr, L with Mission Control.

E2 · 2022 paper (with marking scheme)

Q	Question (marks) · how it was marked	Model outline · where to look
1	Ellen Moore† (Korea): all the multicultural-team interventions the American members used, with evidence (6) · 1 mark name + 1 mark example, three interventions	The key: **structural intervention, adaptation, managerial intervention** (not exit). Name each exactly as Brett et al. do, then one clear case instance that matches the definition (reorganizing tasks or sub-groups; working around cultural gaps; a manager setting norms or escalating). → S10 table.
2	Compare team diversity in Henry Tam, Microsign† and Ellen Moore† (6) · at least 2 similarities + 2 differences, 1.5 each; half credit if the type or the example is unclear	Each point = the **type of diversity** (surface: nationality, age, gender; deep: function, cognitive style, values, goals) + an example from each case. MGI side → **C5**, **D1**.
3	(a) Fit of Jeremy Frazer (Tough Guy†) with team, organization, supervisor and job (4); (b) fit of Edward Gibson with team, supervisor and job (3) · 0.5 for the level + 0.5 for one instance, per fit	(b) P-G **high** (crew "got along very well"; common enemy); P-S **high** with Carr, **low** with Mission Control (evenings filled, more work during insomnia); P-J **high** for the science (solar observations "outstanding"), low for rote work. → **C3**. Either of two adjacent levels (high/moderate) earns the mark if defended.
4	Ellen Moore† on the Big Five (5) · 0.5 level + 0.5 evidence per trait; any defended level gets full marks	Use S1's facet list: O (adapts to Korean culture?), C (delivery, preparation), E (assertiveness), A (cooperation vs confrontation), N (composure under bias). One fact each.
5	Main sources of process loss in the SI team (Ellen Moore†) (5) · one example from each category, 0.5 type + 0.5 evidence	The five categories: **conformity, participation, decision-making biases, conflict, influence** (S12–13). One instance each.
6	Ellen Moore†, Gargi Sinha and Dana Soiman as networkers ("Learn to Love Networking") (6) · four ideas × 1.5 (0.5 per person)	Gargi: strong on all four (learning: day-one meetings with finance and production heads; common interests: D&I with Kamla and the CEO; giving: initiatives, the CSR budget, the GPTW work; higher purpose: women's inclusion) → **C1**. Dana: moderate (common ground with Igor and Henry, none with Sasha; resists the alumni calls; fills MGI's finance gap; wants to work with kids) → **C5**.

E3 · 2012 recall paper

Q1 (6)	As Manish, improve things between Meena and Nitish† (cite readings). → Diagnose the conflict type (S11), then mediate (Brett & Goldberg: separate, then joint), learning conversations (third story, intent vs impact), interests not positions (S5), clear roles (S10).
Q2 (6)	Bob Knowlton's† power sources vs his superior. → French & Raven plus informational and relational (S6): what he controls, knows, and whom he is connected to; note what he lacks.
Q3 (6)	Learnings from Asian Toys in PLP format. → **C7** PLP table.
Q4 (12)	Transactional analysis. Not in the 2026 session plan.
Q5 (10)	Jury in *Ek Ruka Hua Faisla*† through Tuckman. → Forming (jurors meet, first vote nearly unanimous "guilty"), storming (one dissenter challenges the majority; tempers flare), norming (evidence re-examined; norms of reasoned debate), performing (votes shift one by one to a unanimous verdict), adjourning. Add conformity and minority influence (S12–13).
Q6 (6)	Using the X-Y game† in a negotiation. → Cooperation vs competition; trust is fragile; communicate before moving; reciprocity; integrative vs distributive (S5).

E4 · Likely 2026 questions → where to look

Likely question	Go to
Big Five of Ramesh, Gargi or Kamla; Gibson; Lovas or Bennett; Greg James	C1, C3, C8, C6 · S1

Likely question	Go to
Fit (all four types) for Ramesh, Gargi, Gibson, Greg James, Henry Tam	D2 → case · S2
Ramesh's EVLN options and what he should do	C1 · S2
Trust between named pairs	D3 → C1, C5 · S2
Gargi or Dana as a networker; Ibarra's three networks	C1, C5 · S3
Why the FO didn't take control; voice motivators and inhibitors; Swiss cheese; learning	C2 · S4
Integrative negotiation plan (Lewicki's four steps)	S5
Power sources of Mission Control vs crew; conflict antecedents and types	C3 · S6, S11
McGinley's influence tactics, status and framing	C4 · S7
Plan a difficult conversation (Ramesh–Gargi, Lovas–Bennett, Sasha–Dana)	C1, C8, C5 · S8

Likely question	Go to
Belbin roles and Business Chemistry in a team	C4, C5, C8 · S9
Brett's challenges and strategies (Henry Tam, McGinley, Greg James)	C5, C4, C6 · S10
Tuckman or punctuated equilibrium (Skylab, MGI)	C3, C5 · S10
Virtual-team problems at Sun; Ferrazzi; hybrid fairness; trust practices	C6 · S11
Process losses (five categories) and synergy	D6 · S12–13
Compare team diversity across cases	D1 · S14
Asian Toys: crisis elements, the decision, the meeting, media, learnings	C7 · S15
Compare two leaders	D7
Unseen case (like Satera in 2020)	A4 checklist + C8 as the model

F · One-line glossary

Abilene paradox: the group agrees to what nobody wants because no one voices doubt.

Adaptation (Brett): acknowledge cultural gaps openly and work around them.

Affective vs cognitive trust: care and familiarity vs reliability and competence (Dinh).

Allen curve: communication drops steeply with physical distance.

Benevolence vs competence trust: "you won't harm me" vs "you know your stuff" (Abrams).

Betweenness centrality: you sit on paths between people who aren't connected; you broker.

Big Five: openness, conscientiousness, extraversion, agreeableness, neuroticism (OCEAN).

Brokerage network: contacts who don't know each other; diverse information and creativity.

Business Chemistry: Pioneer, Guardian, Driver, Integrator; opposites Pioneer–Guardian, Driver–Integrator.

Closed network: dense ties; trust and support, but echo chambers.

Common-knowledge effect: groups discuss what everyone knows, not unique information.

Conflict types: task (what), relationship (who), process (how), status (rank and credit).

Consensus: an agreement everyone can accept, even if not their first choice.

Core self-evaluation: bottom-line view of one's own worth and capability.

Creative abrasion: productive task conflict, as opposed to personal abrasion.

Crisis elements: ambiguity, high stakes, urgency, rarity, significance, stakeholder impact.

Dark Triad: Machiavellianism, narcissism, psychopathy.

Distributive vs integrative: split a fixed pie vs expand it through interests.

Double-loop learning: question the underlying assumptions, not only the actions.

Dual concern model: concern for self × other → avoid, accommodate, compete, collaborate.

EVLN: exit, voice, loyalty, neglect (active/passive × constructive/destructive).

Exit (Brett): remove a member who can't adjust; last resort.

Faultline: several differences align, splitting a team into sub-groups.

Fit: person–job, –organization, –group, –supervisor compatibility.

Framing: defining the situation so the preferred course looks natural.

Futility: the belief that speaking up won't change anything.

Groupthink: overlooking problems in pursuit of consensus.

HEAR: hedge claims, emphasize agreement, acknowledge perspectives, reframe positively.

Holding: leaders acknowledge and contain emotions and give context in a crisis.

Hybridity positioning: resource access and visibility that come with being in the office.

Inclusion: valuing and using differences; a process, not a head count.

Intent vs impact: what they meant vs how it landed; ask about the first, describe the second.

Interests vs positions: why people want something vs what they say they want.

Katz skills: technical, human, conceptual; the mix shifts with level.

Kipnis tactics: rationality, inspirational appeal, consultation, ingratiation, personal appeal, exchange, coalition, pressure, legitimating, apprising, collaboration.

Learning conversation: explore both stories instead of delivering a message.

Listening triangle: ask, listen, acknowledge, ask again.

Managerial intervention (Brett): set norms early or bring in a higher manager.

Naïve realism: believing your view is objective and others are misinformed.

Networks (Ibarra): operational (do the job), personal (develop yourself), strategic (future direction).

Power bases: legitimate, reward, coercive, expert, referent, plus informational and relational.

Process loss: the gap between potential and actual output: conformity, participation, decision biases, conflict, influence.

Psychological safety: a shared belief that the team is safe for interpersonal risk.

Punctuated equilibrium: long inertia, then a burst of change around the midpoint.

Push vs pull: influence by pressure and argument vs by inclusion, listening and support.

RBS: Reflected Best Self: collect stories of you at your best, find patterns, act on strengths.

Real team (Katzenbach): small, complementary skills, common purpose, goals and approach, mutual accountability.

Receptiveness: willingness to consider opposing views impartially.

Self-monitoring: adjusting behaviour to situational cues.

Single-leader working group: individual accountability under one leader; fast and often fine.

Single-loop learning: fix the action, keep the assumptions.

Situation strength: strong rules and norms mute personality's effect.

Social loafing: less effort in a group than alone.

Speak-up / silence cycle: each response to voice teaches whether voice is worth it.

Status: respect, prominence, prestige.

Structural intervention (Brett): reorganize sub-groups or tasks to reduce friction.

Surface vs deep diversity: visible demographics vs values, cognition, function.

Swiss cheese model: accidents happen when holes in many defence layers line up.

Synergy: the team beats what its members could do alone.

Third story: a neutral description of the disagreement that both sides accept.

Trait activation: traits show when the situation cues them.

Tuckman: forming, storming, norming, performing, adjourning.

Virtual distance: physical, operational and affinity distance.

Voice (Morrison): discretionary upward communication of ideas or concerns to improve things.

Voice ≠ agency: speaking up is not the same as acting (taking control).